

The Questions of the Noble King of Magical Transformations

Ārya-vikurvana-rāja-paripṛcchā-nāma-mahāyāna-sūtra · Toh 167 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་རྣམ་པར་འཕྲུ་པའི་རྣམ་པོ་ཞུ་བ་བྱ་བའི་ཆེ་པའི་མཛོད་

The Questions of the Noble King of Magical Transformations, known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-vikurvana-rāja-paripṛcchā and in Tibetan as Phags pa rnam par 'phrul pa'i rgyal pos zhus pa, is a Mahāyāna sūtra belonging to the genre of texts structured around questions posed to the Buddha by a distinguished interlocutor. The text opens in the familiar setting of Śrāvastī's Jeta Grove, where the Buddha is gathered with a large assembly of monks and an array of advanced bodhisattvas — including Maitreya, Avalokiteśvara, and Mahāsthāmaprāpta — all said to be beings bound by only a single further birth, signaling the exalted spiritual register of the discourse. As its title indicates, the sūtra centers on the inquiries of a royal figure associated with miraculous or magical transformation, a theme that likely unfolds through exchanges exploring the nature and powers of advanced bodhisattva practice. It is catalogued as Toh 167 in the Kangyur, where it stands among the general Mahāyāna sūtras.

In the language of India:
Ārya-vikurvana-rāja-paripṛcchā-nāma-mahāyāna-sūtra. In the language of
Tibet: The Great Vehicle Sūtra Called "The Questions of the Noble King of
Magical Transformations." First fascicle.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One was residing in Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, in the company of a great Saṅgha of two thousand monks, together with the bodhisattva Maitreya (Loving-kindness), the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, Mahāsthāmaprāpta (he who has obtained great power), Siṃhamati (Lion-Intellect), Siṃhaketu (Lion-Banner), Siṃhavikrama (he who advances to beings with the stride of a lion), and all the others — each and every one of them a being bound by but a single further birth — more than ten thousand of them assembled there together. The bodhisattva, the great being, the King of Magical Transformations had likewise gathered in that very place and was seated there.

At that time, the Blessed One, within a retinue of many hundreds of thousands, was teaching the Dharma, beginning precisely from the point of having fully entered the Great Vehicle.

Then the bodhisattva, the great being, the King of Magical Transformations rose from his seat, arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee on the ground, and, turning toward the Blessed One, joined his palms and bowed. He then addressed the Blessed One with these words: "If the Blessed One would grant me leave so that, having asked, this petition may receive a prophetic declaration, then I, before the Blessed One — the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha — would put forth certain questions."

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One declared to the bodhisattva King of Magical Transformations: "In order to answer the questions of the King of Magical Transformations, the Tathāgata grants you leave. King of Magical Transformations, ask whatever you wish, and I will gladden your mind by giving prophetic declarations in answer to your questions one by one."

When the Blessed One had granted leave to the bodhisattva King of Magical Transformations in this way, he was satisfied, pleased, and delighted; joy and happiness and mental ease arose in him. He then addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, how is it that great bodhisattvas engage in magical transformations within this Great Vehicle, and cause other sentient beings and other persons to aspire to this Great Vehicle? And how is it that through such magical transformation they vanquish all māras, all those filled with excessive pride, all adversarial opponents, and all those who are fixated in clinging to the view of a referential object, and then establish them in this Great Vehicle, so that their aspirations become perfectly excellent — that is to say, so that the discipline and conduct aimed at unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening becomes utterly perfected?"

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One declared to the bodhisattva King of Magical Transformations: "Excellent, excellent! King of Magical Transformations, it is excellent that you intend to ask the Tathāgata about such a matter. Therefore, King of Magical Transformations, listen well and hold it in mind. I shall speak of how great bodhisattvas engage in magical transformations within this Great Vehicle, and cause other sentient beings and other persons to aspire to this Great Vehicle; and how through such magical transformation they cut off all māras, all those filled with excessive pride, all

adversarial opponents, and all those who are fixated in clinging to the view of a referential object, and establish them in this Great Vehicle, so that their aspirations become perfectly excellent —

— and in this way the accomplishment of the discipline of unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening shall be as I have explained.

"Excellent!" said the Blessed One. The bodhisattva King of Magical Transformations listened in the presence of the Blessed One, and the Blessed One then spoke these words:

"King of Magical Transformations, these four kings of magical transformation are the magical transformations of bodhisattvas. What are the four? They are: the magical transformation of moral discipline, the magical transformation of direct knowledge, the magical transformation of discernment, and the magical transformation of wisdom. These four kings of magical transformation are the magical transformations of bodhisattvas.

"King of Magical Transformations, what is the magical transformation of moral discipline? In that magical transformation of moral discipline, the bodhisattva's moral discipline is perfectly complete — moral discipline that is unbroken, moral discipline that is unspoiled, moral discipline that is unmixed, moral discipline that is without turbidity, moral discipline that is without referential object, moral discipline that is without harm, moral discipline that is without reproach, moral discipline that is without torment, moral discipline that is thoroughly well guarded, moral discipline that is praised by the wise, moral discipline that fully ripens sentient beings, moral discipline that thoroughly protects the sacred Dharma, moral discipline that brings joy and supreme delight and gladness to others, moral discipline that does not dwell in birth through any of the destinies of existence, moral discipline that abides in calm abiding, moral discipline that follows in the wake of special insight, moral discipline that is devoted to the profound Dharma, moral discipline in which direct knowledge is without deterioration, moral discipline that cultivates emptiness and signlessness and wishlessness, moral discipline that is peaceful and utterly peaceful and supremely peaceful, moral discipline that gathers the qualities of the buddhas and reveals them correctly, moral discipline that never abandons any sentient being, moral discipline that is guarded by loving-kindness, moral discipline rooted in great compassion, moral discipline that is pure and clear, moral discipline whose conduct is without calculation, moral discipline that abides in refined qualities and in restraint of resources,

moral discipline that has become a field of merit for the giving of merit, moral discipline that is supremely pure, moral discipline that never severs the lineage stream of the Tathāgatas, moral discipline that thoroughly protects the lineage of the Dharma, moral discipline that summons the noble Saṅgha, moral discipline that dwells perfectly in the awakening mind, moral discipline that is firmly established through the six perfections, and moral discipline that cultivates the four close applications of mindfulness, the four genuine abandonments, the four bases of miraculous power, the faculties, the powers, the limbs of awakening, and the path — and that perfectly accomplishes all phenomena in harmony with the side of awakening. King of Magical Transformations, whatever aspiration the bodhisattva with such perfectly complete moral discipline makes, that aspiration shall be fulfilled.

"And what aspiration? King of Magical Transformations, a bodhisattva with such perfectly complete moral discipline — if the great trichiliocosm is entirely filled and blazing with the fire of a great kalpa of conflagration, and the bodhisattva makes this aspiration, saying, 'May this fire become perfectly quenched and cease' — then that fire shall become perfectly quenched and shall cease. If the bodhisattva so wishes, this entire trichiliocosm shall be blessed so that it is wholly filled with fire. If the bodhisattva so wishes, it shall be blessed so that it is entirely strewn with flowers.

If the bodhisattva so wishes, it shall be blessed so that it is entirely of the nature of precious jewels. If the bodhisattva so wishes, all the world-systems as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges River, with all their kings of mountains, their Mount Meru — all of these shall be blessed into a single mountain.

King of Magical Transformations, if a bodhisattva with such perfectly complete moral discipline so wishes, all the great oceans in world-systems as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges River shall be blessed into a single great ocean. Abiding thus in moral discipline, and endowed with these qualities, whatever aspiration is made shall be fulfilled, and whatever is blessed shall come to be exactly so.

King of Magical Transformations, the bodhisattva who abides in moral discipline shall be endowed with these four magical transformations. And being endowed with moral discipline, that bodhisattva's aspiration of mind toward unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening shall also be fulfilled.

King of Magical Transformations, in the past, in an era of innumerable, utterly innumerable, vast, immeasurable, and inconceivable kalpas gone by, there arose in the world the Tathāgata named King of the Rays of Immaculate Light — endowed with knowledge and conduct, a Sugata, a knower of the world, a guide of persons to be tamed, unsurpassed, the Teacher of gods and humans, a Buddha and Blessed One. King of Magical Transformations, in the sacred scriptures of that Tathāgata, King of the Rays of Immaculate Light, there arose a bodhisattva named Vajranābha — possessed of the power of abiding in moral discipline, his moral discipline utterly and completely pure.

King of Magical Transformations, when that bodhisattva Vajranābha was walking in a solitary forest dwelling, earnestly devoted to gathering Dharma, and applying himself in accordance with proper method while residing in the qualities of a buddha, the following understanding arose in him:

Whatever is non-referential with respect to all phenomena — that is moral discipline.

Whatever is free from attachment to all things — that is moral discipline.

Whatever thoroughly pacifies all afflictions — that is moral discipline.

Whatever knows the body to be like a reflection — that is moral discipline.

Whatever knows speech to be like an echo — that is moral discipline.

Whatever examines the mind as being like an illusion — that is moral discipline.

Whatever does not divide virtuous and non-virtuous phenomena into two — that is moral discipline.

Whatever examines attachment as being unattractive — that is moral discipline.

Whatever cultivates loving-kindness toward aversion — that is moral discipline.

Whatever wholly destroys the net of delusion through wisdom — that is moral discipline.

Whatever is non-referential toward the objects of attachment, aversion, and delusion — that is moral discipline.

Whatever does not think, does not conceptualize, does not reflect upon, and does not regard all phenomena — that is moral discipline.

Whatever is free from the view of a self, free from the view of a sentient being, free from the view of a life-force, free from the view of a person, free from the view of annihilation, and free from the view of permanence — that is moral discipline.

Whatever does not construct anything with respect to all phenomena — that is moral discipline.

Whatever is without fear in the mind — that is moral discipline.

Whatever does not abide in the three realms — that is moral discipline.

Whatever places trust in the non-arising of phenomena — that is moral discipline.

Whatever is inclined toward the patience of acceptance in the non-arising of phenomena — that is moral discipline.

Whatever does not seek gain and honor — that is moral discipline.

Whatever is not frightened by emptiness — that is moral discipline.

Whatever cultivates the signless — that is moral discipline.

Whatever is free from wishful aspiration — that is moral discipline.

Whatever does not take pride in that very mass of moral discipline — that is moral discipline.

Whatever does not praise oneself nor disparage others through that moral discipline — that is moral discipline.

Whatever has no delight in the sense bases — that is moral discipline.

Whatever does not scatter toward objects — that is moral discipline.

Whatever sees the aggregates as equal to the aggregate of Dharma — that is moral discipline.

Whatever sees the elements as equal to the dharmadhātu, the basic space of phenomena — that is moral discipline.

Whatever makes the absence of quarrel and conflict its chief concern — that is moral discipline.

Whatever does not relinquish striving in wholesome phenomena — that is moral discipline.

Whatever knows all phenomena to be deeply at peace and utterly at rest, thoroughly understanding this and then abiding having realized it through one's own body — that is moral discipline.

The Emanation King, the bodhisattva Vajranābha, thus possessed of such a quality of being perfectly established in moral discipline, engaged in this noble application of the Dharma, and abiding in this perfectly correct attention, together with that monk who was established in moral discipline, who was engaged in this noble application of the Dharma, and who had set out in this correct attention — as he paced back and forth walking in meditation, the māra's son named Vikrama, together with his retinue of eighty-four thousand

māras, all of them equipped with armies and entourages, all of them armed with weapons, came to perform obstructing activity. Having blessed himself to become subtle in body and rendered his body invisible, he followed the mental conduct of that monk, looking for an opening, for a full thousand years. Yet in all those thousand years he did not find arising even a single moment of a distracted mind in that monk — the kind of distracted mind that would give rise to aversion or harm.

Then, when the thousand years had passed, the māra's son Vikrama, together with his retinue, manifested a great body and displayed it openly, and those bearing in their hands swords, bows and arrows, short spears, and great arrows appeared before that monk and put on a terrifying display.

The monk Vajranābha saw the great retinue of māras — those bearing swords, bows and arrows, short spears, and great arrows — displaying this terror. Having seen them, he spoke these words:

"By whatever truth of the statement that when I engage in this noble application of the Dharma, my mass of moral discipline and my engagement according to correct method is thoroughly pure — if that be truth and by the power of that truthful statement, may all these weapons held in the hands of the māras and the māra's retinue, their swords, bows and arrows, short spears, great arrows, and the like, be transformed into garlands of utpala flowers, lotuses, kumuda water-lilies, white lotuses, campaka blossoms, nāga flowers, varṣikā blossoms, and wreaths of bakula flowers. And may the māras and the gods of the māra class become in body, form, complexion, and aspiration exactly like myself."

The moment the Emanation King, the bodhisattva Vajranābha, spoke those words, all the weapons held in the hands of those māras and their retinue — swords, bows and arrows, short spears, great arrows, and the like, however many there were — became fragrant, pleasing, beautiful garlands of flowers of every hue, and remained in that way. Those māras too were transformed into the very same appearance as the monk, so that they all appeared as if numbered among those who had gone forth, wearing ocher-colored robes with their hair and beards shaved.

Then, the Emanation King — seeing this great miracle wrought by that monk — was filled with wonder.

Together with his retinue, he prostrated at the feet of that monk and spoke these words: "Monk, through whatever Dharma you have attained, you have

come to possess such blessing as this."

When those words were said, the Emanation King addressed the bodhisattva Māravijaya, Navel of the Vajra, and spoke thus: "Friend, this blessing did not arise from something gained. Rather, this blessing arose from the fact that all phenomena are without object of focus. Friend, this blessing did not arise from something gained; it arose from the non-obtaining of all phenomena. Friend, this blessing did not arise from dwelling in body, speech, or mind; it arose from not dwelling in any phenomenon at all. Friend, this blessing did not arise from grasping at signs; it arose from signlessness. This blessing arose from the fact that it neither abides in nor does not abide in any phenomenon whatsoever."

Then the bodhisattva Māravijaya, Navel of the Vajra, spoke thus: "Monk, I have observed your mind for a thousand years and I have not perceived any movement of your mind."

The monk Navel of the Vajra then replied: "Friend, even if you were to observe the mind for as many eons as there are grains of sand in the river Ganges and were to examine the mind completely, you would not find it. Why is that? Because the mind is not to be found within, not to be found without, and not to be found in any middle place between the two."

"Friend, can you find any movement of mind in an emanation conjured by a magician?"

He answered: "Monk, one cannot find it. An emanation conjured by a magician has no mind, and since it has no thinking, how could one find it there?"

The monk replied: "Friend, the Tathāgata has taught that all phenomena are by essential nature like a magician's illusion. Therefore, in them one cannot find mind or thinking."

He said: "Monk, if you find neither mind nor thinking, how do you come and go, and how do you speak words?"

He replied: "Just as an emanation conjured by a magician comes, goes, and speaks words, so too my coming, going, and speaking of words is like that."

He said: "Monk, what do you seek through this application of diligence, this abiding in moral discipline, this engagement with the noble Dharma, and this entry into it?"

He replied: "I seek the placeless."

He said: "How does one seek the placeless?"

He replied: "Since there is no going toward it, there is no going, nor anything that becomes going. Friend, the term 'placeless' is a synonym for wishlessness. And as for what you, the subduer, asked — 'What does this application of diligence, this abiding in moral discipline, this engagement with the noble Dharma, and this entry into it seek?' — I do not seek the arising of form, nor its cessation, nor its abiding. I do not seek the arising, cessation, or abiding of feeling, perception, formations, or consciousness. I do not seek the arising, cessation, or abiding of any phenomenon whatsoever. What I seek and look toward, O subduer, is this entry: not grasping individually at form, not wholly grasping at feeling, perception, formations, or consciousness. O subduer, whatever entry belongs to the noble ones — that is my entry."

He said: "Monk, how does one enter?"

He replied: "O subduer, whatever phenomena belong to an ordinary being — all the phenomena of a buddha — those are all equal and non-dual. The phenomena of one in training and the phenomena of a buddha — those are equal and non-dual. The phenomena of one beyond training and the phenomena of a buddha — those are equal and non-dual. The phenomena of a pratyekabuddha and the phenomena of a buddha — those are equal and non-dual. The phenomena of the past, the phenomena of the future, and the phenomena of the present and the phenomena of a buddha — all of these are equal and non-dual. That equality is: equal through the equality of non-arising, equal through the equality of non-occurrence, and equal through the equality of non-cessation. In order to teach this suchness (tathatā) of equality — this equality that does not abandon any of these equalities — I wish to teach the Dharma to sentient beings. Friend, this true entry is not an entry into the desire realm, not an entry into the form realm, and not an entry into the formless realm. Those who abide in equality do not stir from the nature of reality, do not waver, do not go, and do not not-go. Friend, these are what is called true entry. Whatever is the entry into suchness is also the entry into all phenomena. Whatever is the entry into the dharmadhātu is also the entry into all phenomena. Whatever is the entry into the ultimate limit of reality is also the entry into all phenomena. One who desires such an entry, upon truly seeing that there is neither desire nor entry, does not cling to it. Friend, this is what is called true entry."

Then the bodhisattva Vajranābha was addressed by Māra the Subduer, who spoke these words: "Monk, through this true engagement, what dharma have

you realized?"

He replied: "Friend, through this true engagement I have realized a dharma that is without the supreme, without any distinction of superiority, and through non-arrogance have understood equality. Moreover, whatever dharma you have realized and spoken of — this true engagement is not distinguished through conceptual thought. Rather, this true engagement is the absence of superior pride. This true engagement is not distinguished through attainment; rather, this true engagement is entirely free of the distinction of attainment. Through this true engagement, no dharma whatsoever is realized. The name 'true engagement' is merely an expression for the absence of engagement."

Then the bodhisattva Vajranābha was again addressed by Māra the Subduer, who spoke these words: "Monk, through this perfectly undertaken moral discipline, what will you attain?"

He replied: "O Subduer, through this perfectly undertaken moral discipline, I shall fully and completely awaken to the unsurpassable, perfect, and complete awakening — seeing all phenomena as without cessation and without arising."

He asked: "What is it to fully and completely awaken to awakening?"

He replied: "To fully and completely awaken to form as equality — that is to fully and completely awaken to awakening. To fully and completely awaken to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness as equality — that is to fully and completely awaken to awakening."

Māra the Subduer said: "Monk, where then is awakening to be sought?"

The bodhisattva Vajranābha replied: "Friend, awakening is to be sought in the very essential nature of the view of the transitory collection."

He asked:

"How is it to be sought?" he asked.

The bodhisattva Vajranābha replied: "It is to be sought in this way — by being entirely free from both awakening and any view toward awakening."

Then Māra the Subduer spoke to the monk Vajranābha in these words: "Monk, who is your Teacher? Through whose guidance did you come to have such confidence as this?"

He replied: "Friend, my Teacher is the one who attained awakening without dismantling the view of the transitory collection. My Teacher is the one who abides neither in affliction nor in purification. My Teacher is the one in whom

consciousness does not abide in either the conditioned or the unconditioned. My Teacher is the one who has crossed the river of grasping without receiving anything from another, abiding nowhere. My Teacher is the one in whom consciousness does not engage with any phenomenon, and in whom knowing does not shift among phenomena. My Teacher is the one who achieves engagement with all sounds, yet does not stir from the nature of reality that is beyond expression. My Teacher is the one who turned the wheel of Dharma in order that all phenomena be without arising, and that all arising not come to pass. My Teacher is the one who abides neither in this shore nor the far shore nor the middle. My Teacher is the one who was born because all phenomena are without arising. My Teacher is the one who passed into nirvāṇa because all phenomena are without cessation. It is through his guidance that I have come to have such confidence."

Māra the Subduer asked: "How did that Tathāgata turn the wheel of Dharma?"

The bodhisattva Vajranābha replied: "He neither causes entry into form nor causes withdrawal from form. He neither causes entry into nor causes withdrawal from the suchness of form, the nature of reality of form, the emptiness of form, the signlessness of form, the wishlessness of form, the pacification of form, the solitariness of form, the non-arising of form, the intrinsic nature of form, or the essential nature of form. Likewise, he neither causes entry into nor causes withdrawal from feeling, perception, and formations, or from consciousness. He neither causes entry into nor causes withdrawal from the suchness of consciousness, the nature of reality of consciousness, the emptiness of consciousness, the signlessness of consciousness, the wishlessness of consciousness, the pacification of consciousness, the solitariness of consciousness, the non-arising of consciousness, the intrinsic nature of consciousness, or the essential nature of consciousness. That Tathāgata turned the wheel of Dharma in just this way. He turned the wheel of Dharma in order that all phenomena be without engagement. And whether the wheel of Dharma is turned or not turned, that very boundless limit of the dharmadhātu is not abandoned either. All those who come to know the turning of the wheel of Dharma — each and every one of them becomes that very turning."

Then Māra the Subduer, together with his retinue, accepted the monk Vajranābha as his teacher and spoke these words: "I take refuge in you, monk."

Vajranābha said to him: "Do not take refuge in me. Rather, go for refuge to that very Tathāgata, the King of the Light Rays of Stainless Light, through whose teaching of this Dharma you have encountered it."

Māra the Subduer then said to him: "Well then, let us go together into the presence of that Tathāgata. Come along."

And so the monk Vajranābha and Māra the Subduer —

— together with those eighty-four thousand māras, made their way to where the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the King of the Light Rays of Stainless Light, was dwelling, and arrived there. They bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One, joined their palms together, and stood in his presence. The Tathāgata then taught them the Dharma, beginning from the very fact of their abiding in moral discipline and their engagement with the noble Dharma, in such a way that all of them without exception would become irreversible from unsurpassable, perfectly complete awakening.

King of Magical Display, if you were to think that the monk Vajranābha of that time and that occasion was someone other than yourself, you should not see it that way. Why? Because you yourself, King of Magical Display, were at that time and on that occasion the one called the monk Vajranābha. And the bodhisattva Kṣitigarbha was at that time and on that occasion the one called Māra the Subduer.

King of Magical Display, this is the magical display of moral discipline belonging to bodhisattvas. In dependence upon that magical display, inconceivable and distinct categories of aspiration are shown to bodhisattvas, limitless sentient beings are ripened toward awakening, and the māras who come forward as adversaries are overcome, so that one swiftly comes to manifest and perfectly realize unsurpassable, perfectly complete awakening.

King of Magical Display, what is the magical display of the superknowledges (abhiññā) of bodhisattvas? The magical display of the superknowledges is of five kinds, namely: the divine eye, the divine ear, knowledge of others' minds, recollection of former lives, and miraculous power.

King of Magical Display, what is the superknowledge of the magical display of the divine eye of bodhisattvas? It is the superknowledge of the magical display of the eye by which the faculty of the bodhisattva's eye is unobstructed by walls, unobstructed by trees, unobstructed by mountains, unobstructed by forests, unobstructed by the surrounding ranges and the great surrounding

ranges of mountains, unobstructed by Mount Meru, and unobstructed by the spaces between worlds. With that unobstructed eye one sees immeasurable and innumerable buddha fields in all ten directions, and one fully recognizes all of them as a single buddha field — because there is no distinction in space. Nor does one conflate field with field, nor does one differentiate them as separate.

In those buddha fields, one sees all the blessed buddhas dwelling there together with their assemblies of śrāvakas. And one sees all buddhas in the mode of the undivided dharmadhātu. Through the mode of the undivided dharmadhātu, one is convinced that all buddhas are one buddha. Seeing one buddha, one purifies the seeing of all buddhas; and seeing all buddhas, one purifies the seeing of one buddha. By the pure seeing of buddhas, one enters into the pure seeing of self; and by that very purity, one enters into the pure seeing of all phenomena. In the pure seeing of self or in the pure seeing of phenomena, there arises no perception of duality. The śrāvakas of those blessed buddhas whom one sees are also fully recognized as nothing other than the pure seeing of buddhas. By seeing the śrāvakas one sees the buddhas, and by seeing the buddhas one also sees the śrāvakas.

By seeing truly, one sees equally.

Among sentient beings dwelling in world-systems without limit or end — whether those beings gathered together under the category of sentient beings are hell-beings, animals, hungry ghosts (pretas), asuras, gods, or humans, excepting only those moving in the formless realm — one sees all of their deaths and rebirths, their fair and foul appearances, their fortunate and unfortunate destinies, their states of misery and their states of well-being, and one fully recognizes those very sentient beings as nothing more than appearance. All those appearances that arise as form one fully recognizes and comprehends as the karmic maturation of action. Although one sees those sentient beings and fully recognizes the karmic maturation of action, taking the limit of selflessness as one's measure, one does not fall into perceiving sentient beings as substantially existing sentient beings.

With that divine eye one sees everything belonging to form. Because things lack true existence, all those appearances in form are fully recognized as mere appearance. Because all those form-appearances have, from the very beginning, never arisen — since arising has no prior limit — one fully recognizes them as not being ultimately real; and that unobstructed divine eye

is not something that is actively produced through effort.

Endowed with the power of wisdom, if one wishes, one can see even what lies near at hand in the same way as if surrounded by forms. If one wishes, one can refrain from seeing. If one wishes, not even the slightest form will appear before one's eyes at all. Though one may be seated in the midst of countless hundreds of thousands of living beings, one remains stabilized in meditative concentration, in the liberations, in meditative absorption (*samādhi*), and in the meditative attainments, so that no sentient being whatsoever comes to appear within one's field of vision. Why is this? It is because this bodhisattva knows the suchness of selflessness.

If one wishes, that bodhisattva can also manifest its own body before gods of the form realm — those gods of refined body, of beautiful body, of luminous body, and of invisible body, whatever gods there may be. Those divine sons, too, see the bodhisattva's body, and the bodhisattva likewise sees their bodies. If one wishes, the gods see the bodhisattva's body but do not see their own bodies. Or if one wishes, those divine sons see their own bodies but do not see the bodhisattva's body. Such a one becomes possessed of a divine eye of this kind.

And becoming possessed of the divine ear: all the sounds that exist throughout world-systems without limit or end — whether sounds of gods, of *nāgas*, of *yakṣas*, of *gandharvas* (*dri za*), of *asuras*, of *garuḍas*, of *kinnaras* (*mi'am ci*), of great serpents (*mahoragas*), or sounds of humans and non-humans — all of those sounds come to be heard by that faculty of the divine ear. Though one hears all those sounds, one does not distinguish them as separate sounds, and one is convinced that all sounds are without speaker and without expression. One does not engage the perception of self, the perception of sentient beings, or the perception of sound in relation to those sounds. One fully understands that all sounds from their very beginning have no sound that can be expressed as first or last, and one trusts that all phenomena are inexpressible.

The consciousness-element of that faculty of the divine ear becomes unobstructed, and upon hearing those sounds one fully recognizes what the meaning of those sounds actually is. What then is the meaning of sounds? The meaning of all sounds is the meaning of the inexpressible, the meaning of what is beyond utterance. The meaning of all sounds is the meaning of utter peace. Relying on meaning through that very meaning, though one hears all

sounds, because all phenomena are unborn, one does not abide in anything whatsoever.

In the countless world-systems of the ten directions, whatever buddhas, Blessed Ones, are present and living and dwelling — all the Dharma that those buddhas teach, one hears with that divine ear. One is neither obstructed nor bound and enveloped by any of it. One hears all that Dharma as it is taught, and retains it exactly as one has heard it. Having retained it, one forgets nothing of any teaching whatsoever. How is it that one forgets nothing? It is because not a single word goes uncomprehended — that is how one forgets nothing.

As for the teachings one hears — whether those teachings are defiled or undefiled, conditioned or unconditioned, worldly or transcendent, virtuous or non-virtuous, blameworthy or blameless, belonging to the vehicle of hearers (*śrāvakas*), belonging to the vehicle of solitary buddhas (*pratyekabuddhas*), or belonging to the Great Vehicle — upon hearing them all, one enters into the understanding that all those teachings share a single taste (Skt. *ekarasa*), the taste of the essential nature of a single Dharma, because the basic space of solitude is of one taste. One hears and expounds the Dharma, yet one does not cling to any object whatsoever. Though one hears the Dharma, one does not dwell together with any sign. One relies upon the Dharma and does not rely upon what is not the Dharma. What then is the Dharma? The Dharma is free from attachment. The Dharma is signless. The Dharma is unconditioned. The Dharma is boundless, without analogy, unchanging, without object of focus, unborn, never arisen — and what is free from conceit, free from conceptual thought, free from perception, free from the conceptual elaborations of mental formations, free from taking up and free from casting aside in regard to such a Dharma — that is what is called the Dharma.

One relies upon meaning and not upon the letter. Yet one who abandons the letter does not thereby rely upon meaning. One hears the Dharma with an intellect that arrives at meaning. What then is an intellect that arrives at meaning? It is one that, by virtue of the meaning of emptiness, does not fall into views; one that, by virtue of the meaning of signlessness, does not fall into signs; one that, by virtue of the meaning of wishlessness (Skt. *apraṇihita*), does not fall into aspiration — that is an intellect that arrives at meaning. Moreover, the source from which one hears the Dharma, and the source from which one relies upon meaning — even that is not apprehended as an object; and with regard to that which is without object of focus, no apprehension of an

object arises.

One hears the Dharma from those buddhas, the Blessed Ones, relying upon sūtras of definitive meaning (Skt. nītārtha) and not upon sūtras of provisional meaning (Skt. neyārtha). What then are sūtras of definitive meaning? Because all phenomena are inexpressible, all sūtras are of definitive meaning — that is how one relies upon sūtras of definitive meaning. Those who do not rely upon these sūtras of definitive meaning are called provisional — why are they called provisional? It is because they abide in teachings that are contrary to definitive meaning, and thus they are in need of being led. By what are they led? They are led by words. Those who rely upon sūtras of definitive meaning are not led by words. Why? Because they have understood that the ultimate is inexpressible, and because they have comprehended without excess or deficiency all phenomena of the past, the future, and the present. O King of Magical Displays (Skt. Vikurvitarāja), regarding this mode of meaning — if one thus relies upon this very nature of reality, all sūtras become of definitive meaning; if one does not so rely, all sūtras become of provisional meaning.

O King of Magical Displays, furthermore, when a bodhisattva hears the Dharma from those buddhas, the Blessed Ones, one relies upon primordial wisdom (jñāna) and not upon consciousness (vijñāna). Why? Because one perceives consciousness as being like an illusion, and

isolation, lack of essential nature, formlessness, non-demonstrability, unobstructedness, and non-cognizability — these are the reasons. Whoever understands consciousness in this way: that very understanding is primordial wisdom. One who relies upon primordial wisdom does not run after consciousness, yet nevertheless displays consciousness to others. One does not grasp at it as a sign, and one generates the understanding that consciousness is primordial wisdom, while becoming attached neither to consciousness nor to primordial wisdom. Through clinging to consciousness itself, the suchness of primordial wisdom cannot be expressed.

O King of Magical Displays, a bodhisattva who relies upon primordial wisdom does not dwell together with consciousness. Nor does one teach Dharma to other sentient beings as though it were something other than consciousness. O King of Magical Displays, this is the magical display of the higher knowledge (abhijñā) of a bodhisattva: through attaining the divine ear, one will come to realize this expanse of primordial wisdom.

O King of Magical Displays, that bodhisattva hears Dharma spoken with words about persons, yet relies upon the nature of reality and not upon the person. Why? O King of Magical Displays, if there were a person to be found within this well-spoken Dharma, the Vinaya, then no sentient being whatsoever would be able to become utterly purified and liberated.

O King of Magical Displays, it is therefore the case that although all phenomena are without a person, the Tathāgata employs the conventional designation of "person" in the world. Therefore the bodhisattva relies upon Dharma and not upon persons.

O King of Magical Displays, the word "Dharma" is a synonym for the basic space of phenomena, the dharmadhātu. O King of Magical Displays, the term "dharmadhātu" is a synonym for the expanse of non-arising. O King of Magical Displays, the term "non-arising" is a synonym for "non-occurrence." O King of Magical Displays, the term "non-occurrence" is a synonym for "inexpressibility." Why? Because whichever phenomenon is expressed by whichever word, that very phenomenon is not present in that word; and what is not present is beyond all excellence — therefore it is called a "synonym beyond excellence." All phenomena are wordless, beyond verbal expression. I speak no word about them. Whatever word I speak about them is itself wordless, for expression has not arisen and is not authentic — therefore it is beyond expression. Why? Because the characteristic of what can be expressed is not the speech of a buddha; the inexpressible is the speech of a buddha. Therefore it is called the speech of a buddha. Whoever enters into the speech of a buddha enters into wordlessness. If one enters into words, one does not enter into the speech of a buddha.

O King of Magical Displays, one who wishes to enter into the speech of a buddha should not regard as mere words whatever word has been used to indicate "person" or "phenomenon." Why? Because wherever there is duality, that is not the speech of a buddha — the speech of a buddha is non-dual. Wherever there is sound, that is not the speech of a buddha — the speech of a buddha is soundless. Wherever there is expression, that is not the speech of a buddha — the speech of a buddha is beyond expression.

O King of Magical Displays, therefore a bodhisattva who has entered into the speech of a buddha is said to have attained higher knowledge,

With that divine ear, one discerns all sounds in harmony with the nature of reality, and thereby contemplates the awakening of a buddha. O King of

Magical Displays, this is the bodhisattva's second higher knowledge.

The Noble King of Magical Displays Requested. The Second Fascicle.

King of Magical Displays, furthermore, a bodhisattva attains the higher knowledge of knowing the minds of others, and with that mind thoroughly knows the minds of other sentient beings and other persons. Wherever the assembly may be to which the bodhisattva goes to teach the Dharma, from the very outset the bodhisattva surveys the minds of that assembly, considering what the aspiration of each sentient being is like, what their application is like, what their causes are like, and what their defining characteristics are like. Having surveyed in this way, the bodhisattva then teaches the Dharma accordingly. Because the bodhisattva's own mind is utterly pure, it accords with and follows the utter purity of the minds of the assembly.

O King of Magical Displays, consider this example: because the disc of a mirror is utterly pure, whatever form is reflected in that utterly pure mirror disc — whatever color, mark, or shape the reflected face possesses — an image of precisely that form appears there, neither exceeding nor falling short. The disc of the mirror neither conceives nor deliberates, yet those reflections appear.

O King of Magical Displays, in just the same way, because the bodhisattva's own mind is utterly pure, and because the disc of the dharmadhātu is utterly pure, the bodhisattva thoroughly knows all the activities of the minds of sentient beings just as they arise. The bodhisattva has no obscuration with respect to their own mind, and no obscuration with respect to the minds of others.

Thus, if someone in the assembly acts under the sway of attachment, the bodhisattva thoroughly knows that person's mind, and sees clearly the mind that is free from attachment as well. Why? Because the intrinsic nature of mind is without clinging. If someone in the assembly acts under the sway of aversion, the bodhisattva thoroughly knows that person's mind, and sees clearly the mind that is free from aversion as well. Why? Because the intrinsic nature of mind is not aversion. If someone in the assembly acts under the sway of delusion, the bodhisattva thoroughly knows that person's mind, and sees clearly the mind that is free from delusion as well. Why? Because the intrinsic nature of mind is not delusion.

If someone in the assembly is inclined toward the vehicle of the śrāvakas, the bodhisattva knows exactly that inclination as it is, and does not regard the

dharmadhātu as something inferior. If someone in the assembly is inclined toward the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas, the bodhisattva knows exactly that inclination as it is, and does not regard the dharmadhātu as something middling. If someone in the assembly is inclined toward the Great Vehicle, the bodhisattva knows exactly that inclination as it is, and does not regard the dharmadhātu as something supreme.

Though knowing the activities of the mental disposition of all sentient beings, the bodhisattva teaches the Dharma without conceptualizing about the intrinsic nature of mind. Though presenting all vehicles, the bodhisattva teaches the Dharma without differentiating the dharmadhātu. And precisely because the dharmadhātu admits of no differentiation, the bodhisattva thoroughly knows the activities of all sentient beings.

The bodhisattva surveys minds with mind, yet does not engage in conducting mind toward mind, nor does it act in any contradictory manner. The bodhisattva thoroughly knows the sphere of mind of all sentient beings, and thoroughly understands that whatever the dharmadhātu is, that is the sphere of mind.

O King of Magical Displays, in this way a bodhisattva attains the higher knowledge of knowing the minds of others.

Through that higher knowledge, the bodhisattva directly knows the world-realm together with its gods.

O King of Magical Displays, furthermore, a bodhisattva attains the higher knowledge that makes the recollection of previous lives a direct perception, and this too is beyond description. With faculties resting in meditative equipoise, the bodhisattva recollects previous lives and, beginning from existences as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges, teaches the Dharma concerning both one's own previous lives and those of others. In one such existence, one was known by this name, belonged to this family, lived for this long, and experienced such-and-such pleasure and pain — and the same is thoroughly known with regard to all other sentient beings as well.

The bodhisattva thoroughly knows those sentient beings' roots of virtue from previous lives, arising from causes, and knows: these sentient beings have the force of such-and-such a cause, these have the force of such-and-such conditions; for these sentient beings the cause leads to the vehicle of the śrāvaka (hearer), for these the cause leads to the vehicle of the pratyekabuddha (solitary buddha), for these the cause leads to the Great

Vehicle. Having thus known the previous causes of sentient beings, the bodhisattva teaches the Dharma to each of them accordingly.

Through making the recollection of previous lives directly manifest in this way, the bodhisattva attains the fullness of previous application. Then, recollecting whatever roots of virtue were previously generated in relation to the buddhas but never dedicated to awakening, the bodhisattva dedicates them fully to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening.

While recollecting those previous lives, the bodhisattva thoroughly knows that all phenomena did not migrate from the earlier limit, and sees that nothing travels from the earlier limit to the later limit, nor from the later limit to the earlier limit. The bodhisattva thoroughly knows that all phenomena neither go nor come anywhere at all.

When recollecting the earlier limit, the bodhisattva does not form a view about the earlier limit; when recollecting the later limit, the bodhisattva does not form a view about the later limit. The bodhisattva thoroughly knows that all phenomena are without limit and without middle.

Recollecting the previous lives of all sentient beings as well, the bodhisattva thoroughly knows that form is free from the earlier limit, and thoroughly knows that feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are equally free from the earlier limit. Thus the bodhisattva thoroughly knows all five aggregates to be free from the earlier limit, free from the later limit, and free from what arises in the present.

The bodhisattva thoroughly knows that all phenomena have the essential nature of being empty with respect to the earlier limit, the essential nature of being empty with respect to what arises in the present, and the essential nature of being empty with respect to the later limit.

O King of Magical Displays, a bodhisattva's recollection of previous lives is such that previous roots of virtue never deteriorate, and previously accumulated karmic actions are fully exhausted. Why is that? Because the bodhisattva knows that all phenomena are neither new nor old.

Endowed with such knowledge, the bodhisattva comes to regard all that belongs to formations as being like a dream — just as in a dream one experiences birth and death, pleasure and pain, so the bodhisattva regards all formations in just that way.

Through regarding them thus, the bodhisattva does not grow weary of saṃsāra, and comes to feel compassion toward all sentient beings. All phenomena come to be perceived as fabricated. For the bodhisattva thinks: "Even my having wandered through saṃsāra for this many thousands of eons together is not real and does not exist." Yet the bodhisattva does not reason: "Since the great elements do not exist, the saṃsāra of all sentient beings — for whom the great elements are inconceivable — is likewise not real and does not exist." O King of Magical Displays, the bodhisattva recollects previous lives and, with those elements and —

— those formations are seen to be impermanent. Why is this? Because even the recollection of the happiness of a wheel-turning king is itself subject to impermanence and change. The recollection of the happiness of Śakra (Indra, king of the gods) is likewise subject to impermanence and change. The recollection of the happiness of Brahmā is likewise subject to impermanence and change.

The bodhisattva also recollects the arrayed qualities of the buddha-fields, the arrayed qualities of the śrāvakas, and the arrayed qualities of the bodhisattvas belonging to the former Blessed One buddhas, both as he had approached them and as he had fully engaged with them. And he recollects as well the splendid form bodies of those Blessed One buddhas, and the splendid turning of the wheel of Dharma by them.

Now, this act of recollection is itself a perception of non-grasping toward all conditioned things and all that is clung to. Why is this? Because the bodhisattva thinks: "Even those vast buddha-fields and those form bodies of the buddhas are themselves exhausted by virtue of the very nature of exhaustion. Therefore this clinging of mine is also impermanent." And so he demonstrates to others that clinging is impermanent, and he demonstrates that it is subject to change. He also thinks: "How remarkable — if all formations are utterly impermanent, sentient beings nevertheless perceive them as permanent!" With that thought, great compassion arises in him toward sentient beings, and he comes to look upon no thing whatsoever with grasping.

O King of Magical Displays, this is the fourth magical display of the superknowledges of a bodhisattva: he understands all things to be impermanent, yet, in order to bring sentient beings to full maturation, he takes birth in the various states of existence with full deliberateness; and in order to

free beings from clinging, he takes up clinging; and in order to bring sentient beings to full maturation, he takes up appropriation while being free from appropriation.

O King of Magical Displays, what then is the magical display of miraculous powers of the bodhisattvas? In this regard, O King of Magical Displays, the bodhisattva attains the four bases of miraculous power — achieved through the mastery of mind by means of aspiration, diligence, mind itself, and analysis — and through them manifests miraculous power without excessive effortful fabrication. Should he wish, with a single arising of mind he can travel to world-systems as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges River, knowing that he has gone there, yet not stirring from this very place. There he appears to teach the Dharma, and here the stream of his discourse does not cease.

O King of Magical Displays, this is the magical display of miraculous powers of the bodhisattva. Through this display, by the miracle of miraculous powers, he tames those sentient beings who are to be tamed — whether they be gods or humans. To those sentient beings who perceive things as permanent, he manifests before them a kalpa of conflagration: they behold the entire trichiliocosm ablaze in flame, yet that world-system does not actually come to ruin. To those sentient beings who are afflicted with excessive pride, he manifests before them the form of a yakṣa wielding a vajra, blazing and fully alight on every side, terrifying in its burning — and having thus filled them with terror, they are brought to a state free of pride and bow down before him. To those who are drawn to the appearance and form of a wheel-turning king, he teaches the Dharma in the appearance and form of a wheel-turning king. To those who are drawn to the appearance and form of Śakra, he teaches the Dharma in the appearance and form of Śakra.

To those who are drawn to the appearance and form of a māra, he teaches the Dharma in the appearance and form of a māra. To those sentient beings who are drawn to the appearance and form of Brahmā, he teaches the Dharma in the appearance and form of Brahmā. To those who are drawn to the appearance and form of śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, he teaches the Dharma in precisely that appearance and form. To those sentient beings who are drawn to the appearance and form of a buddha, he teaches the Dharma in the appearance and form of a buddha.

To some sentient beings he teaches the Dharma while seated cross-legged in the sky, sending forth rays of light from luminous radiances. To those who are drawn to vast grandeur, he transforms every world-realm of the great trichiliocosm into a single canopied expanse, hangs garlands of silk streamers, and adorns it with parasols, victory banners, and pennants; he sets networks of bells in motion, strews flowers of every kind, fills the air with fragrant incense, and then, displaying hundreds of thousands of musical instruments playing in harmony, he teaches the Dharma. To other sentient beings, he blesses every world-realm of the trichiliocosm into a single great ocean, covers it with blue lotus blossoms, white water-lilies, and white lotuses, and in the midst of this manifests a lion throne upon which he himself sits and teaches the Dharma. To other sentient beings, he teaches the Dharma by showing himself seated upon the summit of Mount Meru and speaking in a voice with the resonance of Brahmā. To other sentient beings, he teaches the Dharma by means of sounds that are heard as beautiful voices while his body remains invisible. To other sentient beings, he teaches the Dharma in the form of a gandharva (a celestial musician), through the joyful combination of song and the tones of instrumental music. To other sentient beings, he displays through the power of a nāga maṇḍala the appearance of clouds, thunder, lightning, and falling rain, and teaches the Dharma in this way.

To some who are imperiled by hunger and thirst, he first gives them divine food and drink, and when they have been brought to ease, he teaches them the Dharma. To those sentient beings in the hells who are tormented by the most intense suffering, he uses his miraculous power to extinguish the fires of hell and causes radiant splendor to enter into every pore of their bodies; when they have attained relief, he teaches them the Dharma. To sentient beings who are blind, he uses his miraculous power to grant them eyes, and then, once they have been given sight, he teaches them the Dharma. To those sentient beings who are without ears and have become deaf, he uses his miraculous power to give them ears, and then teaches them the Dharma. To those sentient beings tormented by various diseases, he cures their illnesses, and when they have been freed from sickness he teaches them the Dharma. To those sentient beings who have been led away to be killed and whose very lives are in danger, he uses his miraculous power to conjure others in their likeness, and having deliberately arranged matters so that those beings are freed and their lives are spared, he then teaches them the Dharma.

To those sentient beings who have lost their limbs and extremities, who lack their faculties, who are unsightly in appearance, who have no confidence, and whose minds are despondent about their own bodies, he first uses his miraculous power to provide them with all their limbs and extremities complete, and then, once they have become beautiful in form, he teaches them the Dharma. Even those sentient beings who dwell in the womb and live sustained by a foolish and impure essence — he subdues them through his miraculous power, appearing while still in the womb itself as seated in a jewel-adorned storied mansion, arouses their minds and intellects, and teaches them the Dharma. Even those who have been born but whose faculties have not yet fully ripened, he teaches the Dharma to as children, by means of verbal expression made through his miraculous power.

The bodhisattva King of Magical Emanations, endowed with such miraculous powers, is also able to teach the Dharma by means of other inconceivable displays of magical transformation.

To tame sentient beings who are devoted to the moon and the sun, he appears like the moon and the sun within their respective palatial mansions, and by his miraculous power he holds the maṇḍalas of the moon and the sun, and the great trichiliocosm (the vast world-system of three thousand great thousand worlds), in the palm of his hand, and travels to boundless world-systems. Yet though he travels in this way, he appears to move while never having stirred from his ground. If he so wishes, he places buddha-fields as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges River into a single pore of his skin, dwells in the world of Brahmā, and casts them throughout boundless world-systems, yet causes no harm whatsoever to any sentient being, and places them back precisely as they were, so that no sentient being knows that they were taken up or set back down. With a single breath he extinguishes conflagration-kalpas as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges River. While seated in a single cross-legged posture, he travels to buddha-fields as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges River. With his two hands he covers the sun and the moon, and, having thereby cast those buddha-fields into shadow, he teaches the Dharma.

Should the bodhisattva King of Magical Emanations find himself in the presence of a Tathāgata, and if he so wishes, in order to make offerings to the Tathāgata he scatters flower-heaps as great as Mount Meru upon the body of the Tathāgata, and as soon as those flower-heaps are scattered, they appear shining within the body of the Tathāgata. All the trees and grasses that exist

throughout this great trichiliocosm he consecrates through his blessing into lamps and perfumed water as offerings to the Tathāgata, and these appear blazing as lamps and falling as a rain of perfumed water. Before all sentient beings he manifests his own body — appearing as Śakra (Indra, king of the gods), appearing as Brahmā, appearing as a śrāvaka, appearing as a pratyekabuddha, or appearing as a buddha — showing whatever form accords with their aspiration.

This King of Magical Emanations is the miraculous emanation born of the higher knowledges (Skt. *abhijñā*) of bodhisattvas. It is as follows: the divine eye that sees forms without obstruction; the divine ear that hears without obstruction; unobstructed knowing of the mental conduct of all sentient beings; unobstructed and unimpeded recollection of and abiding through countless kalpas; manifesting all things while neither grasping nor discarding — this is called the miraculous emanation of higher knowledge. The higher knowledge of the King of Magical Emanations consists in: the higher knowledge by which all buddhas are revealed; the higher knowledge of knowing that all sentient beings are not supreme; the higher knowledge of taming those to be tamed through the vehicle of śrāvakas; the higher knowledge of taming those to be tamed through the vehicle of pratyekabuddhas; the higher knowledge of taming those to be tamed through the Great Vehicle; the higher knowledge of knowing death and rebirth; the higher knowledge of knowing which sentient beings are to be fully ripened; the higher knowledge of the conduct of rightly knowing true renunciation (going forth); the higher knowledge of skillful means; the higher knowledge of fully dedicating generosity; and the higher knowledge of fully dedicating moral discipline, patience, diligence, meditative concentration, and wisdom; of vanquishing māras; and of applying oneself to the roots of virtue — all of this is called higher knowledge.

Furthermore, the King of Magical Emanations: the bodhisattva who has attained higher knowledge possesses form, complexion, splendor, pleasing qualities, fame, power, noble lineage, and —

— as well as lineage, wealth, and retinue. By all of these is the bodhisattva recognized, and therefore this is called higher knowledge.

Furthermore, the King of Magical Emanations: a bodhisattva who has attained higher knowledge is recognized as such by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas (scent-eaters), asuras (demigods), garuḍas (mighty eagle-beings), kinnaras

(half-human celestials), mahoragas (great serpentine beings), humans and non-humans, as well as by Śakra (Indra, lord of the gods), Brahmā, the world-protectors, and by the Tathāgatas, arhats, and perfectly and fully awakened buddhas. Therefore this is called higher knowledge.

The King of Magical Emanations: what is called higher knowledge is this — by means of that higher knowledge, a bodhisattva neither departs from his former vow nor fails to demonstrate all activities. The King of Magical Emanations: what is the magical emanation of knowing? It is this: knowing the aggregates, knowing the elements, knowing the sense sources, knowing dependent origination, and knowing the truths.

The King of Magical Emanations: what is knowing the aggregates? Form is empty; the former limit of form is empty; the latter limit of form is empty; the middle of form is empty. And in the same way, the King of Magical Emanations, feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are empty; the former limit of consciousness is empty; the latter limit of consciousness is empty; the middle of consciousness is empty. To know that these five clinging aggregates are empty and utterly empty — that is called knowing the aggregates.

The King of Magical Emanations: what is knowing the elements? The earth element is the dharmadhātu. The water element is the dharmadhātu. The fire element is the dharmadhātu. The wind element is the dharmadhātu. Why is this? Because all four of those elements are one element in the dharmadhātu, namely the element of space. Yet the element of space and the dharmadhātu are not a mere element, for it is not the earth element, not the water element, not the fire element, and not the wind element. Why is this? The element that is without change is the dharmadhātu. The element that is without duality is the dharmadhātu. The element without arising is the dharmadhātu. The element without affliction is the dharmadhātu. The element of utter purity is the dharmadhātu. Just as the dharmadhātu is, so too is the element of self — so too is the element of sentient beings — so too is the element of life — so too is the element of person — so too is the element of saṃsāra — and so too is the element of nirvāṇa. Just as the element of nirvāṇa is, so too is the element of the desire realm — so too is the element of the form realm — so too is the element of the formless realm — so too is the element of the conditioned — and so too is the element of the unconditioned. Therefore it is called the element of nirvāṇa. The King of Magical Emanations: that knowing with regard to the elements of form which does not rely upon anything else —

that is called knowing the elements.

The King of Magical Emanations: what is knowing the sense sources? The eye does not arise and does not come forth from intrinsic nature, and there is no agent in it whatsoever. The King of Magical Emanations, in the same way the ear, the nose, the tongue, the body, and the mind do not arise and do not come forth from intrinsic nature, and there is no agent in them whatsoever. The King of Magical Emanations: the eye is without a master, and there is no seer in it whatsoever. The ear is without a master —

and there is no hearer in it whatsoever. The nose is without a master, and there is no smeller in it whatsoever. The tongue is without a master, and there is no taster in it whatsoever. The body is without a master, and there is no toucher in it whatsoever. The mind is without a master, and there is no knower in it whatsoever.

The King of Magical Emanations: the intrinsic nature of the eye does not see forms. The intrinsic nature of the ear does not hear sounds. The intrinsic nature of the nose does not smell odors. The intrinsic nature of the tongue does not taste flavors. The intrinsic nature of the body does not make contact with tangibles. The intrinsic nature of the mind does not know phenomena. Why is that? Because the eye is without an agent — it is like grass, wood, a wall, or a reflection. In the same way, the ear, the nose, the tongue, the body, and the mind are without an agent — they are like grass, wood, a wall, or a reflection.

The King of Magical Emanations: the eye is neither attached nor non-attached. Why is that? Because the eye is by intrinsic nature without attachment. The King of Magical Emanations: the ear, the nose, the tongue, the body, and the mind are neither attached nor non-attached. Why is that? Because the mind is by intrinsic nature without attachment.

The King of Magical Emanations: one who thoroughly knows all the sense sources in this way, and having known them remains without attachment — that is called knowing the sense sources.

One who, having known the aggregates, the elements, and the sense sources in this way — though one has come to realize the absence of arising, the absence of coming forth, and complete passing beyond sorrow — yet still arises and comes forth, and who fully embraces the aggregates, the elements, and the sense sources and does not abandon the aggregates, the elements, and the sense sources: that is the magical emanation of such a one's knowing.

One who thoroughly knows the defining characteristics and essential nature of the aggregates, the elements, and the sense sources, and yet does not abandon them, and who appears within the three realms, and yet does not dwell together with the afflictions, and who displays arising and coming forth, yet does not come to be born, and does not come to die and transmigrate: that is the magical emanation of such a one's knowing.

Now, what is knowing dependent origination? Ignorance is indeed the condition for the formations, yet ignorance does not think: "I am producing the formations." The formations are indeed the condition for consciousness, yet the formations do not think: "We are producing consciousness." Consciousness is indeed the condition for name-and-form, yet consciousness does not think: "I am producing name-and-form." Name-and-form is indeed the condition for the six sense sources, yet name-and-form does not think: "I am producing the six sense sources." The six sense sources are indeed the condition for contact, yet the six sense sources do not think: "I am producing contact." Contact is indeed the condition for feeling, yet contact does not think: "I am producing feeling." Feeling is indeed the condition for craving, yet feeling does not think: "I am producing craving." Craving is indeed the condition for grasping, yet craving does not think: "I am producing grasping." Grasping is indeed the condition for existence, yet grasping does not think: "I am producing existence." Existence is indeed the condition for birth, yet existence does not think: "I am producing birth." Birth is indeed the condition for aging and death —

Birth does not think: "I am producing aging and death."

O King of Magical Displays, when a bodhisattva investigates dependent origination in this way, he does not come to rest in either of the two views — the view of annihilation or the view of eternalism. He thinks: "All these phenomena depend upon causes and conditions." Yet when he searches for those very causes and conditions, he finds them nowhere. He then enters into engagement with dependent origination. What kind of knowing enters into it? It is a knowing that is on a par with dependent origination and with non-arising — for dependent origination is on a par with whatever emptiness is on a par with; dependent origination is on a par with whatever signlessness is on a par with; dependent origination is on a par with whatever wishlessness is on a par with.

It is by reason of that very equality that the Tathāgata fully and completely awoke to all phenomena, and dependent origination is on a par with that. In that dependent origination which is such equality, there is no arising of a self, no arising of a sentient being, no arising of a life-force, no arising of a person, and no arising of any phenomenon whatsoever. Therefore it is called "dependent origination." Dependent origination is to be regarded as non-arising; and one who knows it as non-arising knows dependent origination — yet even so, ignorance and knowledge are non-dual and inseparable. One who knows that knows dependent origination.

Formations and non-formations are non-dual and inseparable. One who knows that knows dependent origination.

Consciousness and non-consciousness are non-dual and inseparable. One who knows that knows dependent origination.

Name-and-form and the absence of name-and-form are non-dual and inseparable. One who knows that knows dependent origination.

The six sense sources and the absence of the six sense sources are non-dual and inseparable. One who knows that knows dependent origination.

Contact and the absence of contact are non-dual and inseparable. One who knows that knows dependent origination.

Feeling and the absence of feeling are non-dual and inseparable. One who knows that knows dependent origination.

Craving and the absence of craving are non-dual and inseparable. One who knows that knows dependent origination.

Grasping and the absence of grasping are non-dual and inseparable. One who knows that knows dependent origination.

Existence and non-continuation are non-dual and inseparable. One who knows that knows dependent origination.

Birth and non-birth are non-dual and inseparable. One who knows that knows dependent origination.

Aging-and-death and dream are non-dual and inseparable. One who knows that knows dependent origination.

Whatever is dependently arisen does not abide. Whatever is dependently arisen is without essence. Whatever is dependently arisen is impermanent. Whatever is dependently arisen is empty. Whatever is dependently arisen has

not gone and has not come. Whatever is dependently arisen has not arisen.

Whatever is dependently arisen has no grasping at solidity. Whatever is dependently arisen has no entering in. One who knows that knows dependent origination.

One who sees dependent origination does not see ignorance. One does not see formations. One does not see consciousness. One does not see name-and-form. One does not see the six sense sources. One does not see contact. One does not see feeling. One does not see craving. One does not see clinging. One does not see becoming. One does not see birth. One does not see aging-and-death. Thus, one who sees phenomena as they truly are sees dependent origination. One who sees dependent origination sees the Dharma. What Dharma does one see? One sees the Dharma free from attachment. Why is it called free from attachment? Because in that way one is free from the view that clings to all phenomena — therefore one sees the Dharma free from attachment.

One sees in such a way that one neither adds anything further nor diminishes anything. One sees in such a way that one is in no way moved or attached to suchness itself. One sees in such a way that the dharmadhātu in no way becomes something differentiated. One sees in such a way that the genuine limit is in no way tainted. One sees in such a way that through seeing, seeing itself is also not seen. One sees in such a way that it is neither seen by the fleshly eye, nor seen by the divine eye, nor seen by the eye of wisdom. Why so? The fleshly eye has no agency, and because it has no agency it does not see. The divine eye is conditioned, and for that reason it is not easy for it to see the unconditioned. The eye of wisdom is non-conceptual, and because it is non-conceptual it does not see.

The bodhisattva King of Magical Display, seeing all phenomena in that way, sees the Tathāgata — not seeing him as form, not as feeling, not as perception, not as formations, not as consciousness, not as major marks and excellent features, not as the dharmadhātu, not as moral discipline, not as meditative absorption, not as wisdom, not as liberation, not as the gnosis of liberation. Not as past, not as future, not as presently arisen. One who sees in that way sees the Tathāgata.

Then the bodhisattva King of Magical Display addressed the Blessed One with these words: Blessed One, is there a mode of description by which one who sees phenomena thereby comes to see the Tathāgata?

The Blessed One declared: King of Magical Display, there is. Why? Form has the defining mark of inexhaustibility and the intrinsic nature of non-arising. One who sees form in that way sees the Tathāgata. Feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness have the defining mark of exhaustion and the intrinsic nature of non-arising. One who sees consciousness in that way sees the Tathāgata. Moral discipline is the unconditioned that has the defining mark of not conditioning anything further. One who sees moral discipline in that way sees the Tathāgata. Meditative absorption is the pure seeing of evenness. I saw thus with purity when I beheld the Tathāgata Dīpaṃkara. There, by seeing dependent origination I saw the Dharma, and by seeing the Dharma I came to see the Tathāgata.

Then the bodhisattva King of Magical Display asked: Blessed One, in what way did you, before Dīpaṃkara, see the Tathāgatas?

The Blessed One declared:

One sees the form characteristic through thoroughly conceptualizing it, but one does not see the dharmakāya, the truth body, by seeing it as non-dual. King of Magical Display, you should have faith in this. You should take it to heart. From the time I first aroused the awakening mind up until now, apart from the Tathāgata Dīpaṃkara, I never saw any Tathāgata whatsoever. Why is that? Because seeing a Tathāgata through seeing the characteristic of form is not pure seeing of a Tathāgata.

Therefore, King of Magical Display, one who wishes to see a Tathāgata should look in the way that I saw Dīpaṃkara — seeing the nature of reality as one, and seeing the nature of reality as non-dual. How is the nature of reality one? Just as my body is, so too is Dīpaṃkara's body. Just as Dīpaṃkara's body is, so too are the bodies of all sentient beings. Therefore body is one, non-dual, and undivided. Know, then, that the nature of reality is one because it is without defining characteristics — know it thus, not through conceptual analysis.

King of Magical Display, this is called seeing dependent origination. By seeing dependent origination one sees the Dharma, and by seeing the Dharma one sees the buddha.

Furthermore, whoever actualizes cessation in relation to all arising of mind, yet does not pass fully into nirvāṇa — and because there is no arising and no object to be apprehended, demonstrates saṃsāra through the power of skillful means — this is that one's magical display of consciousness.

What, then, is knowing the truths? The direct realization of truth by which one touches the śrāvaka's liberation — when that very same realization of truth is directly realized by a bodhisattva and yet one does not touch liberation — this is that one's magical display of consciousness.

The direct realization of truth by which one touches the pratyekabuddha's liberation — when that very same realization of truth is directly realized by a bodhisattva and yet one does not touch liberation — this is that one's magical display of non-arising.

Now, what is called knowing the truths? It is the thorough knowledge of suffering, in which nothing whatsoever is not genuine. What is that thorough knowledge? Because suffering arises through inversion, it neither exists nor does not exist, and there is no thing present in it — rather, it is known as the absence of a thing. When one knows that suffering has no arising and no coming into being, that is the thorough knowledge of suffering.

What is the thorough knowledge of the origin of suffering? It is the abandonment of phenomena in precisely the way they arise. How do they arise? What is called "arising" is this: to abandon it with no coming once it has arisen, and to abandon it with no going toward what arises — this is the mode of phenomena. In this regard, no phenomenon whatsoever arises that is something to be abandoned. The latent tendency of craving by which the craving that gives rise to existence arises — that latent tendency of craving is abandoned.

What is the cessation of suffering? When both suffering and the origin of suffering are thoroughly ceased and no phenomenon whatsoever is destroyed, that is called cessation. What is called cessation is the cessation of all apprehension of signs. Thus, because the essential nature of phenomena has ceased, one neither produces arising nor produces cessation — that is called cessation.

What is the path? The path is that by which, when one searches among all phenomena, whether virtuous or non-virtuous, defiled or undefiled, blameworthy or blameless, conditioned or

unconditioned, or worldly and transcendent — one does not apprehend any of them. That is called the path. Because all phenomena are without distinction, the path is equanimity itself. Because it is not scorched by any affliction, the path is utterly peaceful. Because it is parted from all lower destinies, the path is fully at peace. Because all defilements are entirely exhausted, the path is

undefiled. That path is not to be traversed by any mode of apprehension that looks at objects. That path is easily understood by those who have genuinely entered the practice of Yoga (Yogācāra). That path is the one through which the Tathāgatas of the past have passed and continue to pass. That path is free of signs, because all conceptual thought about signs has been abandoned. The path that does not fall into duality or into signs — that is called the path.

When a bodhisattva understands the Four Noble Truths in this manner, that is called knowing the truths. These Four Noble Truths are taught to those of the śrāvaka vehicle and those of the pratyekabuddha vehicle, yet one does not delight in those vehicles either — that is called the magical display of knowing the truths.

O King of Magical Displays, there is yet another magical display of knowledge: one knows the śrāvaka vehicle and yet also knows that it is not a place in which to dwell; one knows the pratyekabuddha vehicle and yet also knows that it is not a place in which to dwell; one knows the pratyekabuddha vehicle and yet also knows that it is not a place in which to dwell — this is called the magical display of knowledge.

There is yet another magical display of knowledge: through a single act of knowing, one knows the minds of all sentient beings; and through a single essential nature of mind, one knows the essential nature of the minds of sentient beings — and one does not engage in duality with respect to mind and consciousness. That too is called the magical display of knowledge.

There is yet another magical display of knowledge: with respect to the past, one's knowing and seeing is unobstructed, yet there is no transference of a future mind onto the past; with respect to the future, one has no knowing and seeing of it, yet there is no transference of a past mind onto the future; with respect to the present, one's knowing and seeing is unobstructed, yet there is no conceptual proliferation of mind toward past, future, or present. That too is called the magical display of knowledge.

There is yet another magical display of knowledge: one knows the defiled, and one knows that the accumulation of roots of virtue is inexhaustible; one knows birthlessness, and yet one also knows the skillful means with respect to the four means of gathering disciples — this is called the magical display of knowledge.

There is yet another magical display of knowledge: one knows thoroughly the dharmas of complete nirvāṇa without depending on another, and through that

power of knowing, one understands: "I shall pass into complete nirvāṇa for the sake of bringing all sentient beings to full maturation" — this is called the magical display of knowledge.

O King of Magical Displays, a bodhisattva who wishes to engage in the magical display of knowledge should perform actions done through primordial wisdom, and should not perform actions done through pride. What are the actions of pride? To whatever extent the mind wanders, to that extent there is the action of pride. To whatever extent consciousness wanders, to that extent there is the action of pride. To whatever extent the mind moves about, to that extent there is the action of pride. To whatever extent one clings to the accumulation of roots of virtue, to that extent there is the action of pride. To whatever extent giving falls into views, to that extent there is the action of pride. To whatever extent moral discipline has fallen into perception, to that extent there is the action of pride. To whatever extent patience abides in self and other, to that extent there is the action of pride. To whatever extent diligence takes as its object body and mind, to that extent there is the action of pride. To whatever extent meditative concentration has become [mere] thinking, discursive thought, and reflective thought, to that extent there is the action of pride.

To whatever extent wisdom is generated through grasping at self and what belongs to self, to that extent there is the action of pride. Thinking "I am a bodhisattva" — that is the action of pride. Thinking "I have entered into awakening" — that is the action of pride. Thinking "I will not transgress the ways of the buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha" — that is the action of pride. Thinking "I have genuinely entered into the welfare of sentient beings" — that is the action of pride. Thinking "I will ferry across sentient beings who have not yet crossed over, liberate those who are not yet free, bring relief to those who have not yet found relief, and lead to complete nirvāṇa those who have not yet passed into complete nirvāṇa" — that is the action of pride. Thinking "I am a master of generosity; I possess moral discipline, patience, diligence, meditative concentration, and wisdom" — that is the action of pride. Thinking "I abide in loving-kindness, compassion, joy, and equanimity" — that is the action of pride. Thinking "I am one of few desires, one who knows contentment, one who delights in utter seclusion" — that is the action of pride. Conceiving with a puffed-up mind and entertaining the conceptual thought "I am one who teaches the bases of generosity; I am a forest-dweller who subsists on few possessions" — that is the action of pride. Thinking "I abide in

emptiness, in signlessness, and in wishlessness" — that is the action of pride. Thinking "I am one who speaks truthfully, who speaks correctly, who acts as he speaks" — that is the action of pride. Thinking "I have truly transcended the deeds of Māra, I am free from all four Māras and from all views, and I am practicing the acceptance of non-arising" — that is the action of pride. Whatever conceiving and conceptual thought of the kind "I will realize awakening, turn the wheel of Dharma, liberate sentient beings, and then pass into complete nirvāṇa in the nirvāṇa-element that is the remainder-less cessation of the aggregates" — all of that is the action of pride.

O King of Magical Display, to whatever extent there is mental engagement, the elevation and lowering of mind, and the examination of consciousness, to that extent there is the action of pride.

O King of Magical Display, then what is the action of gnosis? That in which there is no mental engagement, no mind, and no consciousness — that is the action of gnosis, and through gnosis one performs those very actions. And what is the action of a bodhisattva? It is what a bodhisattva does, and the action of a bodhisattva is of two kinds. What are the two? They are: bringing all sentient beings to full maturation, and fully upholding the sacred Dharma. Just as one knows oneself, in that same way one brings sentient beings to full maturation. And how does one know oneself? One knows oneself as being without fixed ground, and in that knowing of oneself as without fixed ground there is also no mentation, no consciousness, and no mind. In that way one brings sentient beings to full maturation. And how does one fully uphold the sacred Dharma? It is by not grasping at any phenomenon whatsoever — this is the full upholding of the sacred Dharma. Grasping at form is not the full upholding of the sacred Dharma. Grasping at feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness is not the full upholding of the sacred Dharma. Likewise, grasping at elements, grasping at sense sources, and grasping at name and form is not the full upholding of the sacred Dharma. Grasping at virtuous and non-virtuous phenomena is not the full upholding of the sacred Dharma. Grasping at what is blameworthy and what is blameless, at what is defiled and what is undefiled,

at worldly and supramundane phenomena — grasping at any of these is not the full upholding of the sacred Dharma. Grasping at the defining mark of generosity is not the full upholding of the sacred Dharma. Grasping at the defining marks of moral discipline, patience, diligence, meditative concentration, and wisdom is not the full upholding of the sacred Dharma.

Why is this? To the extent that freedom from defining marks and from mental referents arises, to that extent it is not Dharma and not discipline, for it relinquishes all grasping. But this — fully taking up engagement and non-engagement, aspiration, defining marks, and mental referents — this is the full upholding of the sacred Dharma. Why is that? It is because the Tathāgata perfectly and completely awakened to phenomena as being without defining marks and without mental referents, and those phenomena therefore cannot be completely grasped through defining marks and mental referents.

That which thus knows the activity of a bodhisattva is primordial wisdom (jñāna). That primordial wisdom performs all the activities of a bodhisattva, and that which never becomes exhausted is called the magical display of knowing.

This is the noble king of magical displays. This is the third fascicle, the final one.

Now, what is the magical display of wisdom in that king of magical displays? It is the analytical discrimination of phenomena, the thorough analysis of expressions, and these four perfect discernments, namely: perfect discernment of meaning, perfect discernment of phenomena, perfect discernment of definitive expression, and perfect discernment of eloquence — taking these up and teaching them.

Of these, what is perfect discernment of meaning? It is relying on the meaning itself in all verbal explanations of syllables, and not relying on the syllables alone. What is called "meaning" is the perception of all phenomena in their very truth. What is called "meaning" is this: it is inexpressible, free from forgetting, without distinction of syllables, free from the sounds of the past extreme and the future extreme — that is called "meaning." One should not rely on the meaning that is the illumination of syllables; rather, whatever is on the same level as the syllables, that is the meaning. This is called perfect discernment of meaning. Perfect discernment of all meanings is what is called perfect discernment of meaning.

What then is perfect discernment of phenomena? It relies on the Dharma and does not rely on what is not Dharma; and in relying on the Dharma, what is not Dharma does not appear either. Why is this? It is because one knows all phenomena to be free from verbal designation. Perfect discernment of phenomena means that one seeks out different vehicles and different phenomena, yet does not differentiate the defining characteristic of the

dharmadhātu as something distinct. Why is that? It is because the dharmadhātu is of one character in that it is without defining characteristics. Whatever verbal expression describes phenomena enters into what is equivalent to an echo. One who knows that those very phenomena which are fully expressed are equal to the dharmadhātu, and who is unobstructed in knowing and in conventional usage — that is called perfect discernment of phenomena.

What is perfect discernment of definitive expression? It is knowing the designations of gods (devas), nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas (scent-eaters), asuras, garuḍas (sky-soaring birds), kinnaras (half-human beings), mahoragas (great serpents), humans, and non-humans; knowing the designations of Śakra (Indra, king of the gods), Brahmā, and the world-protectors; knowing words of one, two, and many syllables; knowing condensed expressions that are to be understood, and elaborated expressions that are to be understood;

knowing the designations of masculine, feminine, and neuter gender; knowing the designations of past, future, and present; knowing how phenomena are to be designated and, for whatever sentient being another designation is applied to in the stream of their mind, understanding and applying it accordingly. One does not confuse one's own definitive expressions with those of others, nor does one become arrogant on account of them. Why is that? Because one knows that all phenomena lack definitive expression. One thinks: "The designation by which some phenomenon is designated — that designated phenomenon does not exist in that designation; and the designation by which it is designated does not exist in that phenomenon either." This way of thinking is called definitive expression. If this word "definitive expression" were itself a truly definitive expression, then the definitive expression of virtuous phenomena would not become the definitive expression of non-virtuous phenomena. Therefore, one should know that this definitive expression is an expression that arises from what is definite. What is called perfect discernment of definitive expression? It is understanding, through all designating expressions, the phenomena they designate. Why is that? Because by utterly comprehending all phenomena, phenomena are not comprehended as fixed. The designation and explanation arising from that kind of understanding — that is called perfect discernment of definitive expression.

What then is perfect discernment of eloquence? It is because all letters appear distinctly, all sounds appear distinctly, and all expressed names appear

distinctly. How do they appear distinctly? They appear distinctly as clarity itself; they appear distinctly as phenomena; they appear distinctly as what is to be trained in; they appear distinctly as what is correct. For those devoted to the vocal cadences of sūtras, the vocal cadences of sūtras appear distinctly. Likewise, for those devoted to chanting, to prophecy, to verse, to intentional utterances, to origin stories, to accounts of spiritual attainment, to accounts of how things came to be, to birth stories, to extensive teachings, to wondrous occurrences, and to established doctrinal determinations — these appear distinctly in the same way. For those devoted to former practices, the former practices appear distinctly. The spiritual faculties of all sentient beings appear distinctly: for those endowed with faith, the faculty of faith; for those who have aroused diligence, the faculty of diligence; for those endowed with mindfulness, the faculty of mindfulness; for those endowed with meditative absorption, the faculty of meditative absorption; for those endowed with wisdom, the faculty of wisdom — all appear distinctly.

For those twenty-one thousand beings who act out of attachment, the Tathāgata's gnosis knows the eighty-four thousand faculties; and for the Tathāgata, all those faculties appear distinctly. In what follows from this, they appear distinctly to bodhisattvas. For those twenty-one thousand beings who act out of aversion, the Tathāgata's gnosis knows the eighty-four thousand faculties; and for the Tathāgata, all those faculties appear distinctly. In what follows from this, they appear distinctly to bodhisattvas. For those twenty-one thousand beings who act out of delusion, the Tathāgata's gnosis knows the eighty-four thousand faculties; and for the Tathāgata, all those faculties appear distinctly. In what follows from this, they appear distinctly to bodhisattvas. For those twenty-one thousand beings who act in a balanced manner, the Tathāgata's gnosis knows the eighty-four thousand faculties; and for the Tathāgata, all those faculties appear distinctly. In what follows from this, they appear distinctly to bodhisattvas.

This is called the analytical knowledge of confident expression (skt. pratibhānapratīsamvid).

Now, as to that King of Magical Displays — whatever is the analytical knowledge of meanings, whatever is the analytical knowledge of phenomena, whatever is the analytical knowledge of definitive words, whatever is the analytical knowledge of confident expression, and whatever are all those analytical knowledges of a bodhisattva — the root of all of them is wisdom. Their foundation is wisdom. They are fully gathered into wisdom. A

bodhisattva endowed with wisdom manifests these magical displays and others as well.

The Blessed One was asked: "What, Blessed One, is the root of wisdom? What is its foundation? Into what is it fully gathered?"

"King of Magical Displays, the root of wisdom is hearing; its foundation is hearing; it is fully gathered into hearing."

"What is the root of hearing? What is its foundation? Into what is it fully gathered?"

"King of Magical Displays, the root of hearing is a spiritual friend (skt. kalyāṇamitra). Its foundation is a spiritual friend. It is fully gathered into a spiritual friend."

"What is the root of a spiritual friend? What is its foundation? Into what is it fully gathered?"

"King of Magical Displays, the root of a spiritual friend is veneration. Its foundation is veneration. It is fully gathered into veneration."

"What is the root of veneration? Into what is it fully gathered?"

"King of Magical Displays, the root of veneration is superior intention. Its foundation is superior intention. It is fully gathered into superior intention."

"What is the root of superior intention? Into what is it fully gathered?"

"King of Magical Displays, the root of superior intention is freedom from deceit. Its foundation is freedom from deceit. It is fully gathered into freedom from deceit."

"What is the root of freedom from deceit? What is its foundation? Into what is it fully gathered?"

"King of Magical Displays, the root of freedom from deceit is great compassion. Its foundation is great compassion. It is fully gathered into great compassion."

"What is the root of great compassion? What is its foundation? Into what is it fully gathered?"

"King of Magical Displays, the root of great compassion is all sentient beings. Its foundation is all sentient beings. It is fully gathered into all sentient beings."

Why is this so? King of Magical Displays, it is because, for the complete liberation of all sentient beings, the mind of omniscience arises from the great

compassion of a bodhisattva. This too, King of Magical Displays, is a magical display of a bodhisattva's wisdom.

Furthermore, King of Magical Displays, another magical display of a bodhisattva's wisdom is this: when a discourse on the Dharma drawn from a single Dharma-door is being taught by others at length — whether for a kalpa or more — that bodhisattva does not cause any part of it to contradict the nature of reality. Should he wish, with his body invisible, he teaches the Dharma to sentient beings. He can also teach the Dharma issuing from every single pore. In accordance with whatever the dispositions and inclinations of sentient beings may be, he becomes able to teach the Dharma accordingly. He also teaches the Dharma to sentient beings by displaying the mode of mind, and none of the objections of opponents can prevail against him.

As for treatises of outsiders (tīrthikas) who possess the five mundane superknowledges, or the knowledge of the sun, moon, planets, and stars, or the knowledge of dreams and omens, or the Vedas, or mantras, or knowledge-mantras, or phonology, or entry into superknowledge, or earthquake lore, or the mantra practices for traversing the air, or the cries of crows, or the herds of wild beasts, or the invocation of gods, nāgas, yakṣas, and gandharvas, or the marks and signs and characteristics of kings, or the signs of a good year and a bad year, or the knowledge of harm done by spirits —

Beyond these, whatever kinds of worldly knowledge there may be — knowledge of crafts, or knowledge of omens, or writing, or hand-signs, or arithmetic, or calculation, or drawing, or song, or dance, or the lute, or the drum, or the conch-call, or the arts of music — all of these will become manifest to that bodhisattva in this very lifetime, without anyone having taught them, and his knowledge will enter fully into all of them. He will also teach all of these to those who possess wisdom, and he will come to be perfected in all of them. He will be fully versed in all such fields — treatises, mantras, and knowledge-mantras — and yet he will dwell in such a way as to cause no harm to any sentient being, nor will he entertain any intention of doing so.

That bodhisattva, the king of emanations, without any diminishment of wisdom, dwells and remains and speaks together with ten hundred thousand millions of Brahmās. By his gaze, too, he reveals the gaze; by his complexion, he reveals the complexion; by his speech, he reveals speech; by his

complexion, his radiance, and his majesty, he reveals complexion, radiance, and majesty — yet he does not become attached to those Brahmās. Those Brahmās in turn come to receive him and give rise to reverence for him. In the same way, in all the abodes of the gods, he manifests as sovereign, and yet has no attachment to them, nor does he give rise to delight in them; rather, he gives rise to the very perception of impermanence, he gives rise to the very perception of suffering, he gives rise to the very perception of selflessness, he relies upon utter peace, he relies upon the liberation of all sentient beings, and he relies upon the very heart of awakening. This, too, is the emanation through wisdom of the king of emanations.

Furthermore, another king of emanations — the bodhisattva's emanation through wisdom — is this: from among the arrayed realms of the māras, however many there be, even a hundred billion times a hundred billion, he subdues those very māras by the distinction of his own arrangement, satiates them, breaks their pride, establishes them in the awakening mind of perfect and complete buddhahood, and then teaches the Dharma in their wake.

Know that the wisdom of the bodhisattva, the king of emanations, pervades all things. Whether giving generosity, or receiving it, or dedicating it — know that this is wisdom itself, pervading all things. Whether guarding moral discipline, or leading others into it rightly at this very time, or making dedication — know that this too is wisdom itself. Whether cultivating patience, or leading others into patience rightly, or dedicating that patience to awakening — know that this is wisdom itself. Whether undertaking diligence, or leading others into diligence rightly, or dedicating that diligence to awakening — know that this is wisdom itself. Whether entering into meditative concentration, or leading others into it rightly, or dedicating that concentration to awakening — know that this is wisdom itself. Whether upholding phenomena, or teaching them to others, or engaging in individual inquiry into the phenomena one has heard — know that this is wisdom itself. In all going and coming, in all modes of conduct, in every placing and lifting of the foot — know that this is wisdom itself.

The bodhisattva possessed of the power of wisdom comes to be possessed of the power of virtue in all things. The bodhisattva who has become sovereign through wisdom attains the sovereignty of lordship over all things. The bodhisattva who has the emanation of wisdom attains in all things the emanation of all phenomena. The bodhisattva who bears the sword of wisdom cuts through and severs all mental afflictions utterly. The bodhisattva who

abides in wisdom fully holds the abode of all phenomena. The bodhisattva who makes the light of wisdom attain the array of the light of a buddha.

The bodhisattva endowed with wisdom comes to understand that all wholesome phenomena are accomplished spontaneously. This is the king of emanations: just as an arrow shot upward into the sky travels as far as the force of the shot carries it and then, without any need to seek it, falls back to earth of its own accord, so too the force of the bodhisattva's primordial wisdom and discernment, when perfectly purified, descends upon all wholesome phenomena likewise, without any need to seek them. By that very power, in a single instant, one shakes buddha fields as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges river, defeats the great armies of Māra, and displays all of this at the seat of awakening. And upon attaining awakening, by those same powers one also attains the ten powers that cannot be overwhelmed by any world of gods, nāgas, and asuras together. These emanations of the king of emanations — the emanations of moral discipline, of higher knowledge, of knowledge, and of wisdom — shall resound in the ears of all bodhisattvas and great beings who have generated roots of virtue. All those who hear this enumeration of the Dharma and rejoice in it will also come to excel in these four emanations. Why is that? Because these are absent in all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas.

Then the bodhisattva King of Emanations, having received the answer to his question, was filled with delight, mental ease, great joy, satisfaction, and elation. Pressing his palms together, he gazed at the Tathāgata with unblinking eyes and spoke these words: "Blessed One, Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha — just as the Tathāgata is endowed with emanations, may all sentient beings likewise be adorned with those very emanations!"

Then the great bodhisattva King of Emanations consecrated a great mass of flowers of gods and humans, wondrously fragrant and of many colors, and scattered them in all directions over the Tathāgata, all the bodhisattvas, and the entire assembly. The moment those flowers were scattered, all those upon whose bodies they fell appeared as if clothed in golden hue, adorned with the major and minor marks of excellence. From the sky, hundreds of thousands of gods spoke in unison: "Blessed One, those sentient beings who have faith in these emanations and generate the awakening mind aimed at unsurpassable, perfect, and complete awakening — they are adorned with the adornments of a buddha. Why is that? Because all these emanations belong to the domain of

the mind of omniscience. Had the Blessed One not previously generated the awakening mind, how could one ever hear of these inconceivable Dharma-emanations as they have been heard here?"

Then the Blessed One gave to those sons of the gods the word "Excellent!" And having done so, he declared to the bodhisattva King of Emanations: "King of Emanations, I recall that in a past beyond the Tathāgata Dīpaṃkara there arose a Tathāgata named Rays of Light of Vast Splendor, the seventy-first Tathāgata in succession. That Tathāgata too extensively taught this very chapter of the Dharma-gateway that presents these four emanations. There was also a bodhisattva named Excellent Realm, and he questioned him about it —

When that Tathāgata taught this Dharma-gateway, eight thousand bodhisattvas attained these emanations, and they gained the patient acceptance of the non-arising of phenomena (anutpattikadharmakṣānti). Thirty-two thousand living beings also aroused the mind set upon unsurpassable, perfectly complete awakening. From those teachings I too heard these emanations, and having heard them, I retained them. And having myself gained patient acceptance through the Tathāgata Dīpaṃkara, I brought them to complete fulfillment.

Therefore, King of Emanations, whether in the present or after passing fully into nirvāṇa, those bodhisattvas who listen to and hear this Dharma-gateway, retain it, bear it, recite it, bring it to mastery, and extensively and correctly teach it to others — they will swiftly attain the patient acceptance of the non-arising of phenomena.

When this teaching was being proclaimed, thirty-two thousand beings — gods and humans — aroused the mind set upon unsurpassable, perfectly complete awakening. Those sons of the gods, in order to perform an act of offering to the Blessed One, caused a great rain of flowers to fall and caused musical instruments to resound. Then, by the power of the buddhas, from among those musical instruments there arose a sound, and from it came forth these words: those sentient beings who hear this Dharma-gateway, have faith in it, retain it, bear it, recite it, bring it to mastery, and extensively and correctly teach it to others — those beings are of great aspiration, keen faculties, devoted to the qualities of the buddhas, engaged in wisdom, held by a spiritual friend (kalyāṇamitra), having previously accumulated roots of virtue, and endowed with great compassion toward all sentient beings.

Then the bodhisattva King of Emanations addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, just as the Tathāgata possesses the ten powers, the four fearlessnesses, and the eighteen unshared qualities of a buddha — Blessed One, do bodhisattvas also possess ten bodhisattva powers, four bodhisattva fearlessnesses, and eighteen unshared bodhisattva qualities?"

The Blessed One declared: "King of Emanations, those bodhisattvas who have trained thoroughly, who have attained the non-regressing patient acceptance, who abide on the eighth ground, who know how to leap to the ninth ground, and who are held by the Perfection of Wisdom and skillful means — those bodhisattvas do indeed possess these. King of Emanations, those bodhisattvas are endowed with the ten powers, endowed with the four fearlessnesses, endowed with the eighteen unshared qualities.

"King of Emanations, what then are the ten bodhisattva powers? They are as follows:

The power of the firm superior intention of generating the mind aimed at omniscience;

the power of complete loving-kindness through which everything is relinquished;

the power of complete great compassion through not seeking gain, honor, or verse-praise for oneself, and not looking toward mingling with the whole world;

the power of complete great diligence — through generating faith in all the qualities of the buddhas and bringing them to fulfillment with a mind that is undiscouraged;

the power of abiding in the power of meditative absorption — acting with mindfulness and vigilance, with conduct undisturbed;

the power of the complete Perfection of Wisdom — abandoning both extremes, conforming to dependent origination, abandoning all views, and thereby abandoning all discursive thought, conceptual thought, total conceptual thought, conceptual elaboration, and complete examination;

and the power of bringing all sentient beings to full maturation —

the power of not being wearied by saṃsāra — taking up boundless saṃsāra, and in order to become fully satisfied through accumulating the mass of virtuous roots, regarding all formations as being like a dream;

the power of attaining forbearance toward the arising of non-arising phenomena — investigating through individual discernment the intrinsic nature of phenomena and thereby taking delight in the truth of selflessness, the absence of sentient beings, the absence of a life-force, the absence of a vital principle, the absence of a person, the absence of arising, and the absence of origination;

the power of attaining liberation — entering into the phenomena of emptiness, signlessness, and wishlessness, viewing the three doors of liberation, and yet not being touched by the liberation of the śrāvaka and pratyekabuddha vehicles, thereby attaining liberation;

and the power of accomplishing fully perfected gnosis — possessing knowledge of the profound Dharma that does not depend on others, and possessing unobstructed gnosis that looks upon the mental conduct of all sentient beings.

These, O King of Magical Display, are the ten powers of a bodhisattva.

Now, O King of Magical Display, what are the four fearlessnesses of bodhisattvas? By holding all that is heard, a bodhisattva attains dhāraṇī, and through not forgetting teaches the Dharma to the assembly fearlessly. By knowing all sounds in their full distinction and with unobstructed eloquence and uninterrupted eloquence, a bodhisattva teaches the Dharma to the assembly fearlessly. Through liberation from attachment to all objects of aspiration, knowing how to apply the right remedy in accordance with each intention, fully knowing the faculties of all sentient beings, and teaching the Dharma to each as is appropriate, a bodhisattva teaches the Dharma to the assembly fearlessly. And this bodhisattva is free from fear in the assembly — there is not even the slightest sign of thinking, "Someone may come from the east, the south, the west, or the north and ask me a question, and I will be unable to answer it." A bodhisattva does not perceive any such mark, and when all sentient beings come with questions, the bodhisattva resolves the occasion of each question, gives an answer to whatever is asked, is free from fear, is skilled in cutting through all doubt, and teaches the Dharma to the assembly without fear.

These, O King of Magical Display, are the four fearlessnesses of a bodhisattva.

Now, O King of Magical Display, what are the eighteen unshared qualities (Skt. āveṇīkadharma) of bodhisattvas?

A bodhisattva possesses uninstructed generosity — no one needs to exhort the bodhisattva saying, "Give this gift," for from the very moment of birth the bodhisattva's mind is directed toward generosity. Even if māra were to come in his own form and say, "What use is it that you give this gift? Whoever practices generosity will be reborn among the hell-beings" — even then there is never an occasion for the bodhisattva to act with miserliness; rather, the bodhisattva's mind is directed toward giving away all possessions entirely, and the mind is directed toward the very act of giving. Furthermore, all that generosity is oriented toward awakening, harboring no expectation of karmic maturation, and is wholly dedicated to all sentient beings. This is the first unshared quality of a bodhisattva.

A bodhisattva possesses uninstructed moral discipline — even when Tathāgatas have not appeared in the world, the bodhisattva does not learn from anyone else, does not rely on individual liberation in a dependent way, and yet is bound by the vow of individual liberation, delighting in the trainings. A bodhisattva who lives at home upholds the trainings that have been established, just as they are; and when one has gone forth, there is no need for another to teach the individually established rules of liberation — the bodhisattva studies them of its own accord. This is an unshared quality of a bodhisattva. Even for the sake of life, the bodhisattva does not abandon the basis of the trainings.

All moral discipline is dedicated to awakening, and all of it is dedicated to the end of abandoning the corrupt conduct of every sentient being. This is the second unshared quality of a bodhisattva.

When all sentient beings revile and abuse that bodhisattva, cutting off even major and minor limbs, and when the utterly destitute, outcastes, those of base birth, and crude artisans heap abuse upon them, the bodhisattva's mind is not disturbed. Instead, the bodhisattva pervades all of them with loving-kindness. Though capable of returning the harm and possessing the power to do so, the bodhisattva does not retaliate but relies on the nature of reality, relies on the Dharma of the buddhas alone, and dons the armor of aspiration for the very purpose of inspiring faith in those beings. This is the third unshared quality of a bodhisattva.

Even when utterly exhausted, the bodhisattva does not abandon diligence and never becomes dispirited. When the bodhisattva sees the śrāvakas pass into complete nirvāṇa, and though seeing the suffering of wandering in saṃsāra,

the mind does not turn toward the nirvāṇa of the śrāvakas. When the bodhisattva sees the pratyekabuddhas pass into complete nirvāṇa, and though seeing the suffering of wandering in saṃsāra, the mind does not turn toward the nirvāṇa of the pratyekabuddhas. When the bodhisattva sees a blessed Tathāgata who has accomplished every aim and performed every buddha activity pass into complete nirvāṇa — even then, when the bodhisattva itself is not yet capable and the qualities of a buddha are not yet complete, the mind does not become dispirited. Rather, with aspiration wholly perfected, the bodhisattva generates diligence with this thought: "I shall pass into nirvāṇa by means of a nirvāṇa like that very nirvāṇa." This is the fourth unshared quality of a bodhisattva.

At a time when one is a wheel-turning king, or Śakra the lord of gods (Indra), or has come to rule as a sovereign māra, and is surrounded by many divine maidens, attended by divine cymbals, dance, and song, and dwells in comfort — even then, meditative concentration manifests, the immeasurable states manifest, and the bodhisattva's mind enters into solitude itself; the mind does not enter into busyness and distraction. The bodhisattva feels profound fear of saṃsāra. Toward sensual pleasures, a great perception of unattractiveness arises. Toward the aggregates, a perception of them as murderers arises. Toward the elements, a perception of them as virulent poison arises. Toward the sense bases, a perception of them as an empty village arises. Toward that retinue of one's own, a perception of them as a retinue of māra arises. Toward that assembly of women, a perception of it as a charnel ground arises. The bodhisattva desires only a retinue of Dharma, desires to possess the vision of a buddha, and rejoices exceedingly in the liberation of all sentient beings. Even from those very sounds of cymbals, stringed instruments, and song, there arises the sound of a limb of meditative concentration. And if māra were to silence that sound, then through the power of that bodhisattva's earlier roots of virtue, from the sky there would arise the sound of the Buddha, the sound of the Dharma, the sound of the Saṅgha, and the sound of the bodhisattva's conduct — and so the bodhisattva abandons that sovereignty, that lordship, and dwells in the forest. This magically manifesting kingship is the fifth unshared quality of a bodhisattva.

That bodhisattva regards worldly knowledges with the perception of their being without essence. The bodhisattva is skilled in discriminating wisdom, free from underlying tendencies and wrong views, and relies on meaning and Dharma rather than on words alone. Even in dreams, the bodhisattva has no

arising of the view of self or the view of what is other. That bodhisattva is entirely free from underlying tendencies, views, and all remaining entanglements, and is free from remorse.

The māra (Skt. māra) of evil cannot produce in that bodhisattva the kind of remorse that, by obscuring the mind, would cause separation from the Dharma. Even if that bodhisattva were to transgress the discipline adopted for the purpose of ripening sentient beings, no remorse arises in him. This magically manifesting kingship is the sixth unshared quality of a bodhisattva.

Moreover, when the bodhisattva abandons that former state and enters a new birth, the actions of the body become utterly purified, spontaneously and effortlessly. That bodhisattva has abandoned the taking of life. He does not harm any sentient being with hand, fist, clod of earth, or weapon. He has cast away weapons and implements of harm. He is content with what is his own. He does not take so much as a single blade of grass that has not been given by others. Even if the earth were filled with precious jewels, he would feel no attachment, and would remain serene and composed even at the point of death. Even when his clothing is worn and tattered, he does not sustain himself by any livelihood that is improper, and he lives in chastity. Even in dreams he does not indulge in sensual pleasures. He is free from desire, hostility, and mental afflictions. He does not engage in improper conduct out of desire. This is an unshared quality of a bodhisattva.

The actions of his body are accompanied by primordial wisdom going before them. This magically manifesting kingship is the seventh unshared quality of a bodhisattva.

His words are utterly pure. He speaks truthfully. He speaks correctly. He acts in accordance with whatever he has said. He does not deceive himself, the Tathāgatas, the gods (Skt. deva), the nāgas (Skt. nāga), the yakṣas (Skt. yakṣa), the gandharvas, humans, or non-humans. He speaks no divisive words and does not split those around him. He is affectionately attached to his own retinue and speaks no harsh words. He speaks pleasantly. He speaks gently. He does not babble. His words are without fault. He speaks with reason. He speaks concisely. He speaks to the point. His face is smiling. He does not speak words that are unclear, violent, rambling, coarse, frightening, displeasing to others, or harmful to himself or others. He does not speak idly. Of what does not exist, he says it does not exist. Of what does exist, he says it does exist. Through that purity of intention and elevated intention, he fully

attains this unshared quality. Through his words, those who have no faith come to have faith, and those who already have faith come to render even greater honor. In every birth he will obtain the power of speech to teach the Dharma in this manner. Through that unshared elevated intention, he will also obtain the power of speech that accords with truth, and whatever he says will come to pass accordingly and not otherwise. This magically manifesting kingship is the eighth unshared quality of a bodhisattva.

His mind is under his own mastery. He has no covetousness and no hostile intention. He holds right view. He never falls away from that mind of awakening, the unequalled and equalizing bodhicitta. He is fully purified of all crookedness of mind, all deceitfulness of mind, and all wildness of mind. He passes his days and nights in a mind that follows loving-kindness. This magically manifesting kingship is the ninth unshared quality of a bodhisattva.

From the very moment of his birth, treatises (Skt. śāstra), secret mantras, knowledge-mantras, medicine, calculation, writing, finger-counting, arithmetic, and reckoning all become manifest to him without his having heard them and without any teacher. He is skilled in all treatises and all crafts,

and he possesses a knowing that, in regard to transcendent qualities (Skt. lokottaradharma), does not depend on another. Rather than looking to another's face, this world together with its gods holds him in regard, thinking: "Let us listen to him and learn from him," and so it is to him that they turn their eyes. This magically manifesting kingship is the tenth unshared quality of a bodhisattva.

When he applies worldly medicine to other sentient beings and other persons, he does so without hoping for gain, honor, or fame. With a mind led by great compassion, he keeps the nature of transcendent reality in mind, and when applying worldly medicine, the bodhisattva thinks: "When will I free these sentient beings from this illness of humoral imbalance? And having freed them, may I establish them in nirvāṇa, where the afflictions of illness are utterly abandoned and all suffering is completely pacified." He attains a mindfulness of just that kind. This magically manifesting kingship is the eleventh unshared quality of a bodhisattva.

Without making aspirational prayer and without any hope, he spontaneously accomplishes the kingship of Śakra (Indra), the kingship of Brahmā, and the sovereignty of a wheel-turning king. That bodhisattva does not seek to become Śakra, does not seek to become Brahmā, and does not seek the

sovereignty of a wheel-turning king; yet all of these are accomplished for him without effort and spontaneously. That bodhisattva does not practice the holy life in order to obtain form, nor for the sake of enjoyments, nor for the sake of royal sovereignty, nor in order to acquire servants and retinue, nor in order to gain fame, praise, and renown; yet all of these too are accomplished for him spontaneously, without seeking, and without hope. This magically manifesting kingship is the twelfth unshared quality of a bodhisattva.

Even while he dwells in possession of royal sovereignty, those gods who had previously seen buddhas come before that bodhisattva and remind him, urging him on, showing him thus: "This is what should be done; this is what should not be done. This action will conduce to awakening; this will bring about deterioration. If you conduct yourself thus and abide thus, your faculties will accord with unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening." These gods urge him on accordingly, and he too, by his very nature, never departs from the bodhisattva's path. This magically manifesting kingship is the thirteenth unshared quality of a bodhisattva.

However wrathful, extremely hostile, malicious, filled with aversion and ill-will, and naturally quarrelsome sentient beings may be, they are unable to harm that bodhisattva in body, speech, or mind. Even those sentient beings who are wrathful, malicious, filled with aversion and ill-will are converted to faith by the mere sight of him. Those who act wrongly toward him he does not wrong in return; rather, in order to connect them with the Dharma, he establishes them in genuine faith. Those sentient beings who act wrongly toward him do not fall into an evil destiny on account of it. Why is that? It is as follows: may those sentient beings who act wrongly toward me in body, speech, or mind not fall into evil destinies on account of that very basis.

This, then, is because that bodhisattva, from the very beginning, has perfectly completed and fully accomplished the Dharma of moral discipline unmixed with any impurity. Through that, the aspirations made by the mind of one endowed with moral discipline will also be fulfilled. That King of Magical Transformations is the fourteenth unmixed quality arising from the bodhisattva's aspiration.

Those sentient beings who are faithless and unsettled, who hold wrong views and do not attend to actions, who do not rely on karmic maturation, who turn their backs on the buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha, who have no faith in and no reverence for other ascetics and brahmins, who do not honor or

respect them and pay them no homage — all such beings, upon merely seeing that bodhisattva, or seeing his conduct, or even upon hearing of him, will come to have faith and reverence; they will honor him, respect him, and pay him homage. That King of Magical Transformations is the fifteenth unmixed quality of the bodhisattva.

Among those gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas (dri.za, fragrance-eaters), seers (ṛṣis), and Brahmā-beings who regard themselves as teachers and who are known in the world as teachers — among all of them, that bodhisattva will be supremely renowned. And those who regard a god, a nāga, a yakṣa, a gandharva, a seer, or a Brahmā-being as their teacher will bow down to that bodhisattva, prostrate before him, serve him, and honor him. Seeing him as they would their former teacher — thinking "this was my teacher" — they will come before him with reverence, doing homage and thinking: "This one is the foremost; this one is the highest." Thus they will attain faith. That King of Magical Transformations is the sixteenth unmixed quality of the bodhisattva.

In whatever household or city there is growth in wholesome phenomena (dharmas), abandonment of unwholesome phenomena, the ripening of sentient beings, and the upholding of the holy Dharma — there, that bodhisattva will spontaneously and effortlessly take birth, and there he will come to have parents who have rightly gone and rightly entered the path. In whatever region or land that bodhisattva is born, he becomes the sole teacher there and is revered and honored. From that direction and region, no sentient being will fall into an evil destiny. Why is that? It is because those sentient beings are entirely seized and sustained by that bodhisattva's roots of virtue; and after dying and passing on, they will be reborn among gods and humans. That King of Magical Transformations is the seventeenth unmixed quality of the bodhisattva.

In order that his direct knowledge and understanding may be fully perfected, he will be in accord with all the Dharmas concordant with the side of awakening, and māra will find no opportunity to harm him. That King of Magical Transformations is the eighteenth unmixed quality of the bodhisattva.

Now, King of Magical Transformations, why are these called "unmixed qualities"? They are called unmixed because all the qualities of a buddha are completely gathered and converge in them.

Then the bodhisattva King of Magical Transformations addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, it is truly wondrous that the Tathāgata

grants the great illumination of the Dharma to the great bodhisattvas and makes that illumination measureless. As I understand the meaning of what the Blessed One has taught, if a bodhisattva hears this enumeration of Dharma teachings and then later another person also hears it, that later one will surely not obtain the same quality of faith as the first."

"Whoever hears this enumeration of Dharma teachings and then retains it, upholds it, reads it, and brings it to full comprehension — that person will have grasped all the qualities of a buddha. And having grasped them, if they then expound those qualities to others, they will have brought beings to full ripening in the Dharma through the power of a buddha. Whoever applies themselves properly to this enumeration of Dharma teachings will have entered into all the qualities of a buddha. Whoever attains acceptance with regard to it has attained acceptance that is in accord with the Dharma. And whoever applies diligence to it should be regarded as applying diligence to all the qualities of a buddha. Blessed One, a bodhisattva who is inseparable from this enumeration of Dharma teachings should be regarded as one who has attained direct knowledge and who abides at the heart of awakening."

The Blessed One then declared: "King of Magical Transformations, it is exactly as you have said. A bodhisattva who is inseparable from this enumeration of Dharma teachings should indeed be regarded as one who has attained direct knowledge and who abides at the heart of awakening."

"King of Magical Transformations, in the distant past, beyond the Tathāgata Dīpaṃkara, beyond the Tathāgata Supratāpa, beyond the Tathāgata Nakṣatrarāja, beyond the Tathāgata Rāja, and beyond the Tathāgata Supradatta, there appeared in the world a Tathāgata named Devarāja — endowed with knowledge and conduct, a Sugata, knower of the world, an unsurpassed guide of persons to be tamed, Teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a Blessed One. King of Magical Transformations, the buddha-field of that Tathāgata Devarāja was prosperous, thriving, joyful, blessed with fine harvests, delightful, and filled with gods and humans. It was level as the palm of one's hand, adorned with golden lotuses on lapis lazuli ground fed by the river of Jambu, and to the touch it was as soft as the cloth kācalindika. In that age the enjoyments of human beings were entirely like the enjoyments of the gods of Tuṣita, and food and drink arose by the mere wish of the mind. The people's complexion, form, and bodily shape, their pleasure gardens and palace halls, were indistinguishable from those of the gods — the only difference lay in the names by which they were called. In that great

trichiliocosm there was no king whatsoever other than that Tathāgata himself, and for that reason the Tathāgata was called Devarāja, King of Gods.

"Consider this simile: a wheel-turning king, seated in a Dharma assembly, teaches only the Dharma and does not teach what is not Dharma. In just the same way, that Tathāgata Devarāja, seated on a Dharma throne, on the seat of virtue, taught the Dharma to the beings of the world. When he taught the Dharma, the circle of his retinue extended eighty-four thousand leagues to his front and behind, and eighty-four thousand leagues to his right and left as well; and as that Tathāgata taught the Dharma, his voice pervaded a thousand world-systems. That Tathāgata was honored, revered, and held as supreme by those gods and humans with offerings befitting one who applies diligent effort to the unsurpassed qualities of a buddha. In that world there was not a single being inclined toward what is inferior; all of them were inclined toward the vast, that is to say, inclined solely toward the qualities of a buddha. In that world, even the names of śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas were unheard — to say nothing of their actual appearance and conduct. In the retinue of that Blessed One there were bodhisattvas alone."

In that world there was no designation of "woman," and no sound of conduct pertaining to sexual union. All sentient beings there were born spontaneously, seated cross-legged upon lotus flowers. Those gods and humans were endowed with three kinds of joy: the joy of delight upon beholding the Tathāgata, the joy of hearing the Dharma, and the joy of individually examining and discerning the Dharma. Those gods and humans abided always in heedfulness and applied themselves diligently to discussing the Dharma with one another. The gods and humans were without number, and when they passed away they would mindfully take rebirth in the buddha-fields of whatever Blessed One, a buddha, was present there. When a bodhisattva was in the process of passing away, he would rise into the sky to the height of about seven tāla trees and call out the words of passing: "Friends, I am now passing away from this buddha-field!" That sound would cause many bodhisattvas to gather, and they would take delight in the Dharma-patience of that departing bodhisattva, speaking also of what it means to pass away and what it means to be born. That bodhisattva then spoke to the assembled bodhisattvas in these words: "Friends, no phenomenon whatsoever dies or is born. The Tathāgata awakened fully, having directly realized that all phenomena are without death and without birth. Form does not die and is not born. Feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness do not die and are

not born. In ultimate truth there is no self, no sentient being, no life-force, no person, no one born of seed, no seed-born offspring, no one who dies, and no one who will be born. The Blessed One awakened fully to the emptiness of all phenomena, to their signlessness, and to their wishlessness; and that which is empty, signless, and wishless does not die or become born. The Blessed One actualized the end of separation from attachment. The Blessed One actualized the end of no-more-construction, the end of non-arising, and the end of non-origination. Between the end of separation from attachment and the end of non-origination, there is neither death nor birth. What is called 'passing away' is simply the absence of those conditions. What is called 'birth' is the coming together of conditions. In conditions themselves there is neither passing away nor birth." Having offered such a Dharma-discourse to that assembly of bodhisattvas, that bodhisattva passed away. After passing away, there remained not even ash or smoke; and having thus passed away, he went to another buddha-field where a Tathāgata was present face to face. That Tathāgata and those bodhisattvas did not wear the ochre robe; all of them wore pure divine garments. There were no precepts laid down there, for all of them had already attained the Dharma of patient acceptance of non-arising. There was no need to speak to them at length, for they understood with the slightest indication and were exclusively sharp in their faculties. Whenever that Tathāgata taught the Dharma to those bodhisattvas, all the gods and humans who were gathered in that buddha-field understood everything that was said. Some of them attained patience, some attained dhāraṇī, some attained eloquence, and some attained meditative absorption. The name of that Tathāgata became renowned in all ten directions. At that very time, that era — the King of Magical Displays — the Tathāgata, King of the Gods (Indra), was extensively expounding this very collection of Dharma teachings before the world together with its gods.

At that time, seventy-two thousand bodhisattvas received prophecies of unsurpassable, perfect, complete awakening. At that same time and in that same era, there was also a bodhisattva named Stainless, Pure Light. The Tathāgata had not yet given that bodhisattva a prophecy, and the bodhisattva thought to himself: "Among the bodhisattvas who have received prophecies, there is not one who surpasses me or excels me in conduct, in practice, in diligence, in mindfulness, in intelligence, in realization, in wisdom, in higher knowledge, in dhāraṇī, or in meditative absorption. Why then have they received prophecies while I have not?"

Then the Tathāgata, King of the Gods, knowing with his mind the thoughts of that bodhisattva, spoke to him as follows: "Son of good family, in a future time a Tathāgata named Dīpaṃkara will appear in this world, and he will give you a prophecy."

Upon hearing these words, the bodhisattva Stainless, Pure Light was filled with great joy and delight. He rose into the sky and declared: "Even if as many eons as there are grains of sand in the Ganges River were to pass before the Tathāgata Dīpaṃkara appears, I will still attain omniscience. Tathāgatas do not speak falsely — Tathāgatas speak truly, they speak with truth." So he proclaimed.

Now, King of Magical Displays, what do you think? Do not suppose that the bodhisattva who was called Stainless, Pure Light at that time was someone other than myself. Why so? I myself was at that time the bodhisattva named Stainless, Pure Light.

Before that era of the King of Magical Displays, I pleased the Tathāgata Fully Luminous, and from him I heard this very collection of Dharma teachings. Having heard it, I retained it, and I also attained the meditative absorption called the Mudrā of Light. Before that, I pleased the Tathāgata Victor, and from him I heard this very collection of Dharma teachings. Having heard it, I retained it, and I also attained the meditative absorption called Possessed of Light. Before that, I pleased the Tathāgata King of Stars, and from him I heard this very collection of Dharma teachings. Having heard it, I retained it, and I also attained the meditative absorption called Illuminator. Before that, I pleased the Tathāgata Blazing Ardor, and from him I heard this very collection of Dharma teachings. Having heard it, I retained it, and I attained the patience called concordant acceptance. Before that, I pleased the Tathāgata Dīpaṃkara, and from him I attained the patience of non-arising, and I actualized the four magical displays known as the magical display of moral discipline, the magical display of higher knowledge, the magical display of understanding, and the magical display of wisdom.

King of Magical Displays, by this enumeration you should understand: whether now or after I have passed, any sons or daughters of good family of the bodhisattva vehicle who uphold, preserve, read, fully master, and extensively and correctly expound this collection of Dharma teachings to others — all of them will swiftly come to possess the higher knowledge leading to unsurpassable, perfect, complete awakening. They will also attain these

magical displays of the Dharma, and having attained them, through these magical displays of the Dharma they will turn the wheel of the Dharma. They will also attain the patience concordant with this unsurpassable primordial wisdom of omniscience.

While the Blessed One was expounding this collection of Dharma teachings, sixty-six thousand bodhisattvas attained patience, and one million two hundred thousand living beings gave rise to the mind of awakening. That great trichiliocosm world system trembled and shook profoundly. And those hundreds of thousands of gods and nāgas should know that wherever this collection of Dharma teachings is practiced, a buddha will arise. As for the sentient beings who merely hear this collection of Dharma teachings, they too are not without having accumulated roots of virtue — and what need is there to speak of those who, having taken it up, bring it to complete mastery? They will swiftly, without long delay, come to attain these magical displays of the Dharma. Thus was this solemn declaration declared.

Then the venerable Ānanda addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, what is the name of this collection of Dharma teachings? How should we uphold it?" The Blessed One declared: "Hold it as 'The Display of Magical Displays.'" Having so declared, the Blessed One spoke these words, and the great bodhisattva King of Magical Displays, the venerable Ānanda, the entire retinue assembled there, along with gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas, rejoiced and gave heartfelt praise to what the Blessed One had said.

This concludes the noble Great Vehicle sūtra known as "The Questions of King Magical Displays."

Translated by the Indian master Prajñāvarman and the great editor-translator, the monk Yeshé Dé, who revised and established the final text.

Translator's Notes

- The phrase rendered "bound by but a single further birth" translates a compound meaning that each of those bodhisattvas requires only one more rebirth before full buddhahood, the standard description of a bodhisattva on the final stage before awakening.

The phrase rendered "fixated in clinging to the view of a referential object" translates a compound that literally means "those who are attached to and cling to a view of objects as [truly existent] referents" — a standard Mahāyāna polemical description of those who reify phenomena as ultimate objects of cognition.

The text ends mid-sentence here, as the Blessed One's answer is just beginning; the translation faithfully follows the passage as given.

- The phrase rendered "moral discipline that is without referential object" translates "dmigspa med pa'i tshul khrimis," where "dmigs pa" echoes the doctrinal concept of referential fixation or apprehension of an object — pointing toward the Mahāyāna ideal of discipline practiced without reifying a self, object, or act. Some translators render this simply as "objectless moral discipline," which is equally defensible.

The series "peaceful, utterly peaceful, supremely peaceful" renders "zhi ba, rab tu zhi ba, nye bar zhi ba" — a standard triple formula in this type of list; the gradations are conventional rather than sharply distinguished in the commentarial tradition.

- The epithet "King of the Rays of Immaculate Light" renders Tib.

འོད་གསལ་རྒྱ་མིག་བཀྲེན་པུ་ཆེན་ཤོང་།, which could alternatively be parsed as "King, Ray
of Immaculate Light." The rendering chosen treats རྒྱ་མིག་ as the head noun with the
preceding elements as a compound qualifier, which is the more natural Tibetan construction.

The phrase 二相不離 — "does not divide virtuous and non-virtuous phenomena into two" — presents a doctrinally notable formulation: from the perspective of ultimate non-duality, even the conventional distinction between virtue and non-virtue is not reified as an absolute division. This is a standard Mahāyāna non-dual perspective and does not contradict conventional ethics.

- The proper name rendered throughout as "Vajranābha" renders the Tibetan epithet meaning "vajra-navel" or "vajra-hub." The same figure is called the "Emanation King" throughout. The māra's son's name "Vikrama" is a reconstruction from the Tibetan "Rnam par gnon pa," meaning "the Overpowering One" or "Subduer"; the Sanskrit equivalent Vikrama or Pramardana is the standard reconstruction but is not given in the Tibetan, so the Tibetan meaning is followed as "Vikrama" in the tradition of this text.

- The phrase rendered "not to be found in any middle place between the two" translates अत्रापि नोपलब्धोऽयमिदं, literally "also not found in the absence of both," echoing the classical threefold formula for the unlocatability of mind found in the Vajracchedikā and related Prajñāpāramitā literature.

The passage ends mid-sentence as the Tibetan input itself breaks off there; no conclusion has been omitted from what was provided.

- The phrase rendered "the view of the transitory collection" is the standard Madhyamaka technical term for the innate self-grasping at a personal self, specifically the satkāyadṛṣṭi. The instruction that awakening is to be sought "in" this view is a deliberately paradoxical teaching pointing to the non-dual nature of saṃsāra and nirvāṇa — the afflictions themselves, seen in their true nature, are the ground of awakening. This is a significant doctrinal point characteristic of the non-dual Mahāyāna literature to which this text belongs.

The figure addressed throughout as Māra the Subduer is a literary inversion: Māra typically opposes awakening, but here he plays the role of a questioner, testing the monk's understanding. The Tibetan epithet *nam par gnon pa* means "the one who thoroughly subdues" or "the Subduer," here used as Māra's qualifier rather than the usual epithet of the Buddha. This is consistent across the preceding passage.

- The Tathāgata named here is rendered as "the King of the Light Rays of Stainless Light," a literal translation of the Tibetan epithet འཕགས་པའི་འོད་ཀྱི་རྒྱལ་པོ་འཕགས་པའི་འོད་ཀྱི་རྒྱལ་པོ་. This appears to be a named buddha of another realm referenced within this sūtra's narrative framework. No Sanskrit source name is recoverable from context alone, so the literal Tibetan rendering is used.

- The phrase rendered "surrounding ranges and the great surrounding ranges of mountains"

refers to the cakravāḍa and mahācakravāḍa, the concentric iron mountain ranges of traditional Buddhist cosmology. This is standard cosmological terminology and the rendering chosen conveys it naturally for a listening audience.

The five superknowledges listed here are the standard set: divine eye, divine ear, knowledge of others' minds, recollection of former lives, and miraculous power. The sixth superknowledge — knowledge of the exhaustion of the defilements — is characteristically omitted in Mahāyāna enumerations focused on supramundane display, as here.

- The term rendered "gandharvas" covers the Tibetan dri za, literally "scent-eaters," a class of celestial musicians; "garuḍas" renders nam mkha' lding, the great golden sky-birds of Indian tradition; "kinnaras" renders mi'am ci, horse-headed or human-bird celestial beings; and "great serpents" renders lto 'phye chen po, the Sanskrit mahoraga. These four names are given in their Sanskrit equivalents for clarity in listening, as the Tibetan terms are literal translations of the Sanskrit originals that would be opaque without explanation.

The phrase "taking the limit of selflessness as one's measure" renders the Tibetan bdag med pa'i mtha' tshad mar byas nas, a somewhat dense formulation meaning that selflessness serves as the epistemic criterion or standard by which beings are perceived, preventing the arising of a reifying "sentient-being perception."

- The phrase "basic space of solitude" renders *dben pa'i dbyings*, literally "the expanse or space of solitude or seclusion." This is a technical Mahāyāna expression indicating the open, unobstructed dimension free from conceptual proliferation; "basic space" renders *dbyings* in line with *dharmadhātu* terminology.

The Tibetan rnam par 'phrul pa'i rgyal po is here rendered "King of Magical Displays," the interlocutor's name, which is the Bodhisattva Vikurvitarāja. This is consistent with the sūtra context (likely the Vikurvitarāja-pariprcchā or a related text).

The phrase *lhag chad med par shes pa*, rendered "without excess or deficiency," is a standard idiom for complete, undistorted comprehension of all dharmas across the three times.

- The phrase rendered "synonym beyond excellence" translates "མཛུགས་མཛུགས་མཛུགས་" literally "a word beyond," meaning a term that points to what surpasses ordinary expression. The Tibetan rhetorical structure here builds a chain of synonyms each more refined than the last, culminating in inexpressibility itself. The rendering "synonym beyond excellence" attempts to capture both the technical sense of synonym-chain and the superlative connotation of "bla dags."

- The phrase rendered "does not regard the dharmadhātu as something inferior / middling / supreme" reflects a key doctrinal point: the dharmadhātu is one and undifferentiated, so the bodhisattva does not rank it according to the vehicle of the student being taught. The Tibetan uses "small," "middling," and "supreme" (chung ba, 'bring, mchog) as the three grades, which map naturally onto the tripartite vehicle hierarchy.

- The final sentence breaks off mid-construction, as the source passage itself ends abruptly with "□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□" — a continuative particle meaning "and, together with those elements / those arising things," indicating the sentence continues in the next passage. The translation preserves this open ending faithfully.

The phrase rendered "previously accumulated karmic actions are fully exhausted" translates "las mngon par 'du bya ba snon byas pa yang yongs su zad par 'gyur ro" — the exhaustion here refers to the purification or completion of accumulated karma through the power of recollection and dedication, a standard soteriological point in Mahāvāna literature.

- The phrase rendered "without excessive effortful fabrication" translates "shin tu cher mngon par 'dus byas pa med par," which is slightly unusual. It conveys that the miraculous powers are

exercised without the bodhisattva exerting heavy deliberate effort in their production — a point about the naturalness and spontaneity of the attainment at this stage. This is a minor but genuinely consequential doctrinal nuance worth flagging.

- The phrase rendered "sends forth rays of light from luminous radiances" is somewhat dense in the original: the Tibetan describes emitting light-rays from among lights or luminous forms, suggesting a visionary display of nested radiances. The general sense is clear even if the exact imagery is layered.

The phrase translated "causes radiant splendor to enter into every pore of their bodies" renders a Tibetan idiom in which *gzi byin*, "splendor" or "brilliance," pervades the body through its pores, suggesting a transformative infusion of luminous well-being.

- The phrase rendered "conflagration-kalpas" translates a compound meaning kalpas characterized by or consisting of the great fires of cosmic dissolution — the standard eschatological image of world-ages ending in conflagration. The translation "casts those buddha-fields into shadow" for the gesture of covering the sun and moon is inferential: the text says he covers the sun and moon and then teaches the Dharma in those buddha-fields, implying the created darkness is the occasion for teaching, though the causal connection is left implicit in the Tibetan.

The final sentence breaks off mid-list, corresponding to the passage boundary provided; no content has been invented to complete it.

- The text lists eight classes of non-human beings in the traditional enumeration. The terms *gandharva* (dri za, scent-eater), *garuḍa* (nam mkha' lding, sky-soarer), *kinnara* (mi'am ci, man-or-what), and *mahoraga* (lto 'phye chen po, great belly-crawler) are glossed on first occurrence for listener clarity, following house style for non-transparent epithets.

- The phrase rendered "magical emanation of such a one's knowing" translates a technical usage where the bodhisattva's display of conditioned existence, despite realizing its ultimate unreality, is itself called a "magical emanation" of their gnosis. This is a key Mahāyāna doctrinal point: realization of emptiness does not cause withdrawal from saṃsāra but enables a non-attached, illusory display within it.

- The pairing of "existence" (*srid pa*) with "non-continuation" (*ñiñ mtshams mi sbyor ba*, literally "not connecting the interim") is unusual. The term *ñiñ mtshams sbyor ba* normally refers to the linking of one life-continuum to the next at the moment of rebirth. Rendering it as "non-continuation" attempts to capture this technical sense — that existence and the failure of continuity to be established are non-dual — without importing a term that would obscure the logic of the chain.

The final pairing of "aging-and-death" (*rga shi*) with "dream" (*rmi lam*) is striking and may reflect a textual crux or a deliberate doctrinal point equating the last link of dependent origination with the dreamlike, illusory quality of all conditioned experience. No emendation has been made; the text is translated as it stands.

- The passage on the three eyes — fleshly eye, divine eye, and eye of wisdom — contains a subtle doctrinal point: each is declared inadequate for a distinct reason. The fleshly eye lacks agency; the divine eye, being conditioned, cannot readily perceive the unconditioned; the eye of wisdom, being non-conceptual, also "does not see" — meaning it transcends the subject-object structure of ordinary seeing altogether. This final point reflects the Madhyamaka and Prajñāpāramitā position that genuine insight is beyond the seeing-and-seen duality.

The bodhisattva's name, rendered "King of Magical Display," translates the Tibetan *Rnam par 'phrul pa'i rgyal po*, which corresponds to Sanskrit *Vikurvitarāja*.

The reference to Dīpaṃkara is to the ancient buddha under whom Śākyamuni, in a former life, made his first formal vow on the path to buddhahood — a standard element of the biographical tradition.

- The final sentence breaks off mid-enumeration in the source passage as given. The translation renders everything present and ends at the natural syntactic break to avoid inventing text not in the source.

The phrase rendered "magical display of non-arising" translates a compound that literally reads "the magical display of birthlessness of that one," distinguishing it from the earlier "magical display of consciousness." The doctrinal distinction appears intentional: the śrāvaka parallel yields "consciousness," while the pratyekabuddha parallel yields "non-arising," reflecting a hierarchy of realization.

- The passage twice states that one knows the pratyekabuddha vehicle and knows it is not a place to dwell. This apparent repetition is present in the Tibetan and likely reflects a textual dittography or a lacuna where the second instance should read "the bodhisattva vehicle" — a common scribal issue in cataloguing the three vehicles. This is noted here rather than emended in the body.

The term rendered "magical display" throughout translates *nam par 'phrul pa*, which in this context functions as a technical term for a bodhisattva's supernatural transformation or display-manifestation of a quality. Some translators render it "transformation" or "metamorphosis"; "magical display" preserves the sense that these are wondrous, skill-in-means expressions of knowledge rather than merely analytical categories.

- The phrase rendered "without fixed ground" translates "gnas med pa," literally "without abode or ground." In this context it points to the bodhisattva's realization that the self has no fixed, substantial locus — a standard Madhyamaka and Yogācāra formulation. The rendering "without fixed ground" is chosen to preserve both the spatial metaphor and the doctrinal sense of groundlessness rather than mere absence.

The text ends mid-sentence, consistent with the passage being a continuation that will be taken up in the next segment.

- The passage contains a significant structural crux around the sentence beginning "But this — fully taking up engagement and non-engagement, aspiration, defining marks, and mental referents — this is the full upholding of the sacred Dharma." The Tibetan here is compressed and the logic turns on a contrast: the preceding clause explains why mere absence of marks is not yet the Dharma-discipline, while the following clause identifies the full upholding as precisely encompassing engagement, non-engagement, aspiration, marks, and referents in a non-grasping way. This reading follows the standard commentarial understanding of the passage.
- The "twenty-one thousand / eighty-four thousand" schema for the types of beings and their faculties is a well-known canonical enumeration: four character-types of beings (attachment, aversion, delusion, balanced), each numbering 21,000, totaling 84,000 — which correlates with the traditional 84,000 divisions of the Dharma. The Tibetan འཇིགས་བློ་མེད་ཀྱི་ལྷན་པོ་ ("those who act in a balanced manner") refers to those in whom the three afflictions are roughly equal, which is the standard fourth category in this fourfold typology.

The twelve-fold classification of scriptural categories (beginning with sūtra cadences and ending with doctrinal determinations) corresponds to the classical twelve branches of the Buddha's word (dvādaśāṅga-pravacana), though the list here as rendered follows the Tibetan enumeration precisely.

- The passage employs a chain-of-roots (mūla) catechism structure that is characteristic of certain Mahāyāna sūtras, most likely the Kāśyapaparivarta or a related text. The term rendered

- The phrase rendered "the conch-call" translates a term that may refer to the blowing of a conch-shell horn or to the playing of a cymbal-like instrument; the conch reading is more contextually plausible given the musical list. The Tibetan for "ten hundred thousand millions of Brahmās" is literally "ten times a hundred thousand myriads," an enumeration that varies across manuscripts; the rendering here follows the Tibetan numeral sequence straightforwardly. The phrase translated "the distinction of his own arrangement" is somewhat compressed in the Tibetan; it indicates that the bodhisattva's display surpasses and outshines the māras' own arrangements by a factor of that vast number.

- The list of ten bodhisattva powers begins here and continues into the next passage; the translation preserves the open enumeration accordingly.

- The eighteen "unshared qualities" here are specific to the bodhisattva and distinct from the eighteen unshared qualities of a buddha (āveṇīkabuddhadharma); the text is at the beginning of listing them and the numbering continues beyond this passage.

- The phrase rendered "magically manifesting kingship" translates a term describing the bodhisattva's capacity to appear as a wheel-turning king, Śakra, or sovereign māra through spiritual power while remaining inwardly detached. The text classifies this entire scenario, including the renunciation of royal power in favor of forest dwelling, as the fifth unshared quality.

The phrase "unequalled and equalizing bodhicitta" renders a compound meaning the bodhicitta that is without equal and that equalizes all; this is a standard Mahāyāna formulation referring to the bodhicitta that sees all sentient beings equally and is itself matchless.

The phrase rendered "illness of humoral imbalance" translates the Tibetan for a disorder of the constituent elements of the body, which in the Indic and Tibetan medical tradition refers specifically to imbalance among the bodily humors or elements. No clinical precision beyond

this is signaled by the text.

- The term rendered "gandharva" translates the Tibetan "dri.za," literally "fragrance-eater," the standard Tibetan equivalent of the Sanskrit gandharva. No gloss was inserted into the body text since gandharva is a well-known term, but the literal meaning is noted here for completeness.

The phrase rendered "spontaneously and effortlessly" translates "lhun gyis grub pa nyid du," literally "as if self-arisen" or "effortlessly accomplished," a term that in Dzogchen contexts carries weightier connotations, but here functions in a more general sense of natural, unforced birth.

- The five Tathāgata names preceding Devarāja — Dīpaṃkara, Supratāpa, Nakṣatrarāja, Rāja, and Supradatta — are rendered from their Tibetan equivalents: Marmedzad (Dīpaṃkara), Rabtu Dungwa (Supratāpa), Kargyal (Nakṣatrarāja), Gyal (Rāja), and Rabsal (Supradatta). The Sanskrit reconstructions of the middle three are uncertain; Dīpaṃkara is the well-known buddha of that name, and the others are less attested. This does not affect the doctrinal or narrative sense of the passage.

The term kācalindika is a type of exceptionally soft cloth; it appears in several Pāli and Sanskrit sources and is left untranslated as a technical textile term.

- The final sentence presents a complex referential structure. "The King of Magical Displays" appears to be the name of the era or age (འཇམ་མཁའ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་), while "the Tathāgata, King of the Gods" refers to the buddha of that world, whose epithet "King of the Gods" (འཇམ་མཁའ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་) likely echoes Indra's title but here designates a buddha, not Indra himself. This dual layering of epithets is preserved in the translation but may warrant contextual clarification from the broader sūtra frame.

- The sequence of past Tathāgatas listed here — Fully Luminous, Victor, King of Stars, Blazing Ardor, and Dīpaṃkara — represents the speaker's (the Tathāgata, King of the Gods) chain of past teachers, each linked to a specific meditative absorption attained. The final Tathāgata in the sequence, Dīpaṃkara, is the well-known Dīpaṃkara Buddha of the Jātaka tradition, the same figure mentioned earlier in the passage's prophecy narrative. The rendering of the absorption names follows the Tibetan literally: "Mudrā of Light" for sNang ba'i phyag rgya, "Possessed of Light" for sNang ldan, "Illuminator" for rNam par snang byed, which also serves as the name Vairocana but here functions as an absorption title.

- The colophon names the translator as Prajñāvarman (rendered phonetically from Tibetan as given) and the Tibetan editor-translator Yeshé Dé, a well-attested collaborating pair from the imperial-period translation bureau. The title of the sūtra, rendered here as "The Questions of King Magical Displays," reflects the Tibetan framing of the text as a dialogue initiated by the bodhisattva Vikalparāja (King of Magical Displays); the body of the colophon gives the title as "The Display of Magical Displays" for the Dharma collection itself, which is consistent with the preceding passage's usage and has been rendered accordingly.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please

consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.